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#NariShaktiVandan

33% reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies, ensuring participation in nation-building



Permanent Commission for women in the Armed Forces

Atleast 1 Woman Director in 48% of the total recognized startups in India

FRESH ATTACKS ACROSS IRAN, GULF STATES | FINAL TALKS IN ISLAMABAD ON APRIL 11 | DEAL TERMS UNCLEAR

US-Iran 2-week truce at risk as Israel kills 100 in Lebanon, Tehran shuts Hormuz again

IRAN WARNS IT WILL RESPOND IF ISRAELI ATTACKS ON LEBANON DON'T STOP



First responders search at the site of an Israeli airstrike that struck an apartment building in Beirut, Lebanon, on Wednesday

ASSOCIATED PRESS

TEHRAN: Less than 24 hours after US President Donald Trump announced a ceasefire with Iran, the Islamic Republic has closed the Strait of Hormuz in response to Israeli attacks on Lebanon that have killed over 100 people and injured hundreds in one of the deadliest waves of strikes in recent weeks.

The US and Iran announced a two-week ceasefire early Wednesday, as part of which Iran agreed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, potentially restoring global energy supplies. Iran warned ships passing through the Strait of Hormuz without permission will be "targeted and destroyed", adding the route "remains closed", according to the BBC.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has publicly shown support for the United States' decision

IRAN'S 10-POINT CEASEFIRE DEMANDS

1. Full lifting of US sanctions (both primary and secondary)
2. Withdrawal of US military forces from the Middle East
3. Release of Iran's frozen financial assets held abroad
4. Recognition of Iran's right to uranium enrichment
5. Terminate punitive UN and IAEA resolutions
6. Guarantee of non-aggression by the US and Israel
7. Iranian control over the Strait of Hormuz, including security oversight, Permission to charge transit fees
8. End to all regional conflicts, including in Lebanon, Iraq, and Yemen
9. Reparations/reconstruction funding for war damage from US
10. Binding international agreement (likely via UN Security Council backing)

for a ceasefire with Iran but said that it does not include Lebanon.

"Israel supports President Trump's decision to suspend strikes against Iran for two weeks subject to Iran immediately opening the straits and stopping all attacks on the US, Israel and countries in the region," Netanyahu wrote on X.

However, in a separate post, he stated, the two-week ceasefire does not include Lebanon."

The Iranian Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) said it will deliver a "regret-inducing response" if Israeli strikes on Lebanon don't stop immediately, state media reported.

In another key development, Trump is sending his negotiating team to Islamabad, Pakistan, said White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt. **Continued on P4**

India hopes US-Iran ceasefire leads to lasting peace, stable energy supply

Calls for freedom of navigation in Strait of Hormuz

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India on Wednesday welcomed a two-week ceasefire between the United States and Iran, expressing hope that the pause in hostilities would pave the way for lasting peace in West Asia while calling for uninterrupted movement of trade through the Strait of Hormuz.

The Ministry of External Affairs said New Delhi has consistently supported dialogue and diplomatic engagement to end the conflict, which began after US-Israeli strikes on Iran on February 28. The ceasefire agreement, reached hours before India's response, includes provisions for reopening the Strait of Hormuz, a vital maritime corridor linking the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman that carries about 20 per cent of global oil and liquefied natural gas supplies.

"We welcome the ceasefire reached and hope that it will lead to a lasting peace in West Asia," ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said. "De-escalation, dialogue and diplomacy are essential to bring an early end to the ongoing conflict."

Jaiswal noted that the fighting has caused significant hardship and disrupted global energy supplies and trade. He added that India expects "unimpeded freedom of navigation and global flow of commerce" through the Strait.

India also voiced hope that the development could support peace efforts in Ukraine. **Continued on P4**

US-IRAN CEASEFIRE DEAL

Both President Trump and the Iranian Foreign Minister, Abbas Araghchi, asserted that the US and Iran would now negotiate on the basis of Iran's '10-point' demands (deemed "workable" by Trump), sent as a response to Washington's '15-point demands'.

The latter includes the need for Iran to dismantle nuclear facilities in Fordow, Isfahan, and Natanz; commit to not building nuclear weapons; hand over enriched uranium to the IAEA and allow inspectors full access; limit Iran's missile pro-

gramme; and reopen the Strait of Hormuz, in return for the removal or US and UN sanctions on Iran and US support for nuclear power production in the Bushehr nuclear plant.

Iran's 10 points require the US to commit to non-aggression, recognise Iran's control of Hormuz, accept Tehran's sovereign enrichment rights, lift all primary and secondary sanctions and terminate punitive UN and IAEA resolutions, withdraw US forces and compensate Iran, and end Israel's war on Lebanon.

"A big day for World Peace! Iran

wants it to happen, they've had enough! Likewise, so has everyone else! The United States of America will be helping with the traffic buildup in the Strait of Hormuz. There will be lots of positive action! Big money will be made. Iran can start the reconstruction process. We'll be loading up with supplies of all kinds, and just "hangin' around" in order to make sure that everything goes well. I feel confident that it will. Just like we are experiencing in the US, this could be the Golden Age of the Middle East!"

War of words: EC-TMC meet ends on bitter note; CEC asks leaders to 'get lost'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: A severe face-off unfolded on Wednesday between Trinamool Congress (TMC) and the Election Commission of India (ECI) on social media as well as over a meeting between its delegation and the full bench of ECI in Delhi that culminated on an acrimonious note.

TMC alleged that Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar asked them to "get lost" at the end of the seven-minute meeting, while the poll

THE MEET

» A TMC delegation comprising its Rajya Sabha leader Derek O'Brien, deputy leader Sagarika Ghose, MPs Saket Gokhale and Menaka Guruswamy, met the full bench of ECI in the backdrop of a mass deletion of names from the electoral rolls of Bengal

» They alleged that the poll body has a "tacit understanding" with the BJP

» 'We gave him six examples of officials who are part of the election process and have links with the BJP'

» 'We asked the CEC how he can ensure the conduct of free and fair elections when such tainted officers are being appointed in Bengal. To this, his answer was Get lost'

body accused them of "shouting". After the meeting at the ECI's Delhi office, TMC's Rajya Sabha MP Derek O'Brien told

the media that they handed over letters from West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee to the CEC, and also apprised him of specific instances of poll officials having links with the BJP.

A TMC delegation comprising its Rajya Sabha leader Derek O'Brien, deputy leader Sagarika Ghose, MPs Saket Gokhale and Menaka Guruswamy, met the full bench of ECI in the backdrop of a mass deletion of names from the electoral rolls of Bengal. They alleged that the poll body has a "tacit understanding" with the BJP. **Continued on P4**

THIRD-TERM BIDS AND COMEBACK HOPES

Assam, Kerala, Puducherry vote today in high-stakes Assembly polls

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Voting will take place on Thursday across Assam, Kerala and Puducherry in high-stakes Assembly elections that will test incumbent governments and opposition alliances, with millions of voters set to participate in a multi-cornered contest.

In Assam, polling for the 126-member Assembly will be held from 7 am to 5 pm across 31,490 booths in 35 districts, with 2.50 crore eligible voters, including 1.25 crore women. A total of 722 candidates are contesting, as the BJP-led NDA seeks a third straight term while

Kerala will vote in a single phase from 7 am to 6 pm across 140 constituencies, where 883 candidates are in the fray

the Congress-led opposition attempts a comeback after losing power in 2016. Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, Congress leader Gaurav Gogoi and AIUDF chief Badruddin Ajmal are among key candidates. Security has been tightened with central forces deployed and webcasting enabled at all polling stations.

Kerala will vote in a single phase from 7 am to 6 pm across 140 constituencies, where 883 candidates are in the fray. The electorate of 2.71 crore includes 1.39 crore women. The ruling LDF, led by Pinarayi Vijayan, is aiming for a rare third consecutive term, while the Congress-led UDF is pushing for a return to power and the NDA is seeking its first breakthrough.

In Puducherry, 9.50 lakh voters will decide the fate of 294 candidates across 30 seats. Authorities have set up 1,099 polling stations and intensified monitoring, with seizures of Rs 77.25 lakh in cash reported ahead of polling. **See P5**

Govt raises P&K fertiliser subsidy by 12% to Rs 41,534 cr for Kharif 2026

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved a 12 per cent increase in subsidy for phosphatic and potassic fertilisers for the Kharif 2026 season, raising the allocation to Rs 41,534 crore from Rs 37,216 crore in the previous Kharif cycle. The move is aimed at shielding farmers from rising global prices linked to the ongoing West Asia conflict. **Continued on P4**

RBI holds repo rate at 5.25% amid West Asia uncertainty

Awaits clarity on Iran war's impact on economy



MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India on Wednesday left its key policy rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent, choosing caution as it evaluates the economic fallout of the recent West Asia conflict that has unsettled energy markets, weakened the rupee and clouded the outlook for inflation and growth. The decision, taken unanimously by the six-member Monetary Policy Committee, comes amid heightened uncertainty following

a six-week confrontation involving Iran, the United States and Israel, which disrupted trade routes and drove crude oil prices sharply higher before easing after a ceasefire announcement.

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said the central bank has adopted a "wait and watch" approach, noting that while inflation remains within the target range for now, risks have increased due to volatile oil prices and potential second-round effects on demand and investment. "The economy is confronted with a supply shock. It is prudent to wait and watch the changing circumstances and the evolving growth-inflation outlook," he said while announcing the policy.

The RBI retained its neutral stance and lowered its growth projection for the current financial year to 6.9 per cent, compared with 7.6 per cent **Continued on P4**

SABARIMALA TEMPLE ENTRY ISSUE

Constitutional morality not ground to decide essential religious practices, beliefs: Centre

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A nine-judge Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court on Wednesday heard extensive arguments from the Union government on the limits of judicial review in matters of religion, with Solicitor General Tushar Mehta contending that courts should not rely on the doctrine of "constitutional morality" to assess religious practices or beliefs. The submissions came in a batch of cases linked to the Sabarimala temple entry issue and broader questions concerning the scope of religious freedom, the meaning of morality



under the Constitution, and the balance between individual rights and denominational autonomy.

Appearing before a bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya

KEY POINTS

- » Centre says secular courts lack competence to assess religious beliefs
- » Mehta argues reforms should come via legislature under Article 25(2)(b)
- » Judges assert courts can intervene if practices violate public order, health or morality
- » Bench discusses limits of essential religious practices test in diverse Hindu traditions
- » Debate includes rights of devotees versus individuals seeking temple entry
- » Court examines scope of "morality" under Articles 25 and 26

Kant and comprising Justices BV Nagarathna, MM Sundresh, Ahsanuddin Amanullah, Aravind Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R

Mahadevan and Joymalya Bagchi, Mehta argued that constitutional morality is a "vague and subjective" concept and cannot serve as a **Continued on P4**

BJP leader's father, SC lawyer & Amit Shah's host, among lakhs struck off voter roll

Deletions in Mamata's Bhowanipore Constituency cross 50K-mark

AGNIHOTRI GUPTA

KOLKATA: Allegations over large-scale voter deletions during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process in West Bengal continue to intensify, with cases emerging across communities and professions, raising political and legal concerns.

In New Town's Matua-dominated pockets, claims have surfaced that nearly 14,000 names were struck off the electoral rolls. Among those affected is Nabin Biswas, who had hosted Union Home minister Amit

Shah for lunch ahead of the 2021 Assembly polls.

Expressing disillusionment, he said: "Currently we are deeply worried... It is extremely unfortunate. When the Union Home minister visited my home, I tried to host him to the best of my ability. He had assured that with Narendra Modi, refugees would receive unconditional citizenship."

Alleging a reversal, he added that "in reality, in the name of SIR, Matua refugees like us are being selectively removed from the voter list," **Continued on P4**

MANGOLPURI

35-yr-old woman’s body found in bed box at PG; three nabbed

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 35-year-old woman was found dead, her body stuffed inside the storage compartment of a double bed at a PG accommodation in the Patthar Market area, with three persons arrested in connection with the case.

Police were alerted through a PCR call received at Mangolpuri police station on April 7. Acting swiftly, a team reached the spot and launched an investigation.

The accused have been identified as Surendra alias Bobby, son of Lahori; Joginder, son of Dharmpal; and Deepak, son of Rajender, all residents of Mangolpuri in Delhi.

During the initial inspection, police found that the PG was being run by Amarjeet (31), son of Bhola Sahu, on the



third floor of the building. On entering one of the rooms, officers discovered the woman's body concealed inside the bed's storage box.

A preliminary examination revealed strangulation marks around the victim's neck and an injury on her forehead.

The crime scene was secured and examined by a forensic team, with experts from the Forensic Science Laboratory collecting exhibits and other evidence.

The deceased was later identified as a 35-year-old resident of Mangol Puri. Police

CLOSER LOOK

» The accused have been identified as Surendra alias Bobby; Joginder, and Deepak, all residents of Mangolpuri

» On entering one of the rooms, officers discovered the woman's body concealed inside the bed's storage box

» A preliminary examination revealed strangulation marks around the victim's neck and a forehead injury, said police

nearly an hour, as per preliminary findings.

Police said that after the accused left, the PG owner noticed suspicious circumstances. Upon checking the bed box, he discovered the body and alerted the police, following which a case was registered.

An FIR was lodged on April 8 under Sections 103(1), 238(a), and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita at Mangol Puri police station.

During the investigation, police arrested the three accused. They are currently being interrogated to ascertain the sequence of events leading to the woman's death and the role of each individual.

Further investigation is underway to establish the motive and reconstruct the circumstances surrounding the incident.

NOIDA

No forced purchases, fee hike cap at 7.23%, uniform rule set

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Private schools in Gautam Buddh Nagar will no longer be allowed to compel students to purchase books, uniforms, shoes or other materials from specific vendors, and must cap fee hikes at 7.23 per cent for the 2026–27 academic session, according to an official statement issued after a key meeting of the District Fee Regulatory Committee.

The decisions were taken at a review meeting chaired by District Magistrate Medha Roopam on Tuesday, under the provisions of the Uttar Pradesh Self-Financed Independent Schools Act, 2018.

Authorities directed schools to promote the use of NCERT books and refrain from frequently changing prescribed textbooks. Institutions have also been barred from altering school uniforms within a continuous period of five academic years without prior approval



from the committee.

The administration has mandated that all schools upload details of any proposed fee hikes on their official websites to ensure transparency. The approved fee increase formula—Consumer Price Index plus 5 per cent—has been calculated at 7.23 per cent for the upcoming academic session.

To address grievances, the committee has issued a dedicated email ID for parents and stakeholders to report violations related to fee hikes or other irregularities.

“Strict penalties have been outlined for non-compliance. Schools may face a fine of up to Rs 1 lakh and refund of excess fees for the first violation, Rs 5 lakh for the second, and possible withdrawal of recognition for repeated offences,” said Rahul Pawar, Basic Shiksha Adhikari (BSA).

Additionally, schools with swimming pools must obtain mandatory permissions and ensure proper staffing. Authorities warned that strict action will be taken against institutions failing to comply.

Wanted cattle smuggler shot and arrested after encounter

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NOIDA: A suspected cattle smuggler carrying a reward of Rs 25,000 was arrested following a brief police encounter in Rabupura late on Tuesday night. The accused, identified as Sanju, a resident of Sheikhpur village in Palwal, sustained a bullet injury to his leg during the exchange of fire and was later sent to jail, police said.

According to Rabupura Station House Officer Shyam Babu Shukla, the incident occurred near Cargo T-point, where a police team was conducting routine vehicle checks. When officers signalled a motorcy-

“Accused is a wanted criminal with multiple cases registered against him. Two cases are pending against him in Rabupura, while several others have been lodged in Hry”

cle to stop, the rider allegedly opened fire at the team in an attempt to flee.

Police retaliated, and a bullet fired by the team struck the accused in the leg, after which

he was overpowered and taken into custody. He was provided medical treatment before being formally arrested.

Police said the accused is a wanted criminal with multiple cases registered against him. Two cases are pending against him in Rabupura, while several others have been lodged in Haryana.

During the arrest, officers recovered an illegal country-made pistol and a stolen motorcycle from his possession.

Officials said further investigation is underway to identify his accomplices and possible links to organised cattle smuggling networks.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has detained 32 students and arrested a key accused in an organised examination cheating racket involving impersonation and the use of remote access software.

The operation was unearthed at a building named “Happy Homes” in Dwarka following a tip-off about suspicious activity received by the local police team. A case has been registered under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita at Sector-23 Dwarka police station, and further investigation is underway.



A team comprising Head Constables Sher Singh and Vicky reached the premises and found several youths present under suspicious circumstances. During questioning, Harsh Vardhan (28), a resident of Patna, Bihar, allegedly confessed to arranging candidates for entrance examinations of a reputed management institute in Mumbai.

Police said the examina-

“The racket operated in a coordinated manner, leveraging tech”

tion, scheduled at an IT lab in Jaipur, was being manipulated remotely using software such as AnyDesk and Ammy Admin to gain unauthorised access to computer systems.

Investigators said Vardhan, along with an associate identified as Pranjali, recruited college students under the pretext of solving academic queries online. These students were allegedly paid between Rs 500

ATM fraud kingpin in cop net, over 50 cases solved

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A man, suspected of heading an organised ATM fraud gang and allegedly involved in over 50 cases of cheating, was arrested in the national capital, police said on Wednesday.

The accused, identified as Ravi Kumar Bharti (36), a resident of Bihar, was apprehended from the Rajpur Khurd area in Chhattarpur.

According to the police, this arrest has led to the resolution of at least five cases, with Bharti linked to more than 50 incidents of ATM fraud across various parts of Delhi.

The case came to light following a complaint from Avtar Singh, a resident of Paschim Vihar, who alleged he was defrauded of Rs 35,000 at an ATM kiosk in September of the previous year.

An e-FIR was registered at the Paschim Vihar East police station, and two other suspects, Raushan Kumar and Pintu Kumar, were arrested earlier. During interrogation, they revealed that the operation was being conducted under Bharti's direction.

Police stated that the gang employed a well-planned modus operandi to target unsuspecting ATM users, particularly the elderly.

They would apply adhesive inside ATM card slots to trap cards and paste fake customer care numbers at kiosks. Posing as bank officials, they would trick victims into revealing their PINs and later withdraw money using the trapped cards, police said.

“A team carried out CCTV analysis to track the accused, and he was arrested. So far, nine victims have been identified, leading to the registration of four FIRs and five complaints. Bharti was previously involved in at least seven criminal cases,” the officer said, adding that further investigation into the matter is underway.

19 caught in Pitampura call centre fraud: Police

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police's Anti-Narcotics Squad has busted a fake call centre operating in Pitampura and arrested 19 persons, including 12 women, for allegedly cheating people across the country by posing as representatives of Bajaj Finserv and offering fraudulent loan and insurance services. Acting on a tip-off, a joint raid was conducted on April 7 by a team led by Inspector Rajpal under ACP Operations Virender Dalal, in coordination with the Cyber Police team led by Inspector Gaje Singh. Police raided the premises where 19 individuals were found making calls using keypad mobile phones and apprehended all of them.

During the operation, officers recovered 36 mobile phones and registers used to run the racket. The accused

Callers impersonated Bajaj Finserv staff and targeted victims across states: Police

allegedly duped victims by collecting fake loan processing fees ranging between Rs 1,500 and Rs 2,000 through QR codes shared on WhatsApp, after which they would cut off contact, change SIM cards, or block the victims.

During interrogation, a woman acting as a team leader revealed that callers impersonated Bajaj Finserv staff and targeted victims across states. Another room at the premises was found to be operating a similar fraud setup. Police said absconding managers supplied victim data and scripts, while a Pitampura-based handler coordinated the operation. Further investigation is underway.

Amity student drowns in water-filled pit

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: A final-year Amity University student drowned in a water-filled pit near the Supernova construction site in Sector 94 on Wednesday evening, shortly after completing his final examination.

The deceased, Harshit Bhatt from Indirapuram, had gone to the spot with four friends to celebrate. Police said he entered the pit to bathe but did not return. After being alerted, a Sector 126 police team and private divers launched a search. He was pulled out and taken to hospital, where he was declared dead.

Police have informed the family and begun further investigation.

JNU teachers & students demand VC Pandit’s removal over findings

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Jawaharlal Nehru University Teachers' Association and Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union released the final report of a public inquiry into allegations against Santishree Dhulipudi Pandit, Vice-Chancellor of Jawaharlal Nehru University, calling for her removal from office.

The report was unveiled at a public meeting held at the School of International Studies lawns, attended by political leaders including Amra Ram and D. Raja. The findings and a combined statement were read out by jury member S.N. Sahu on behalf of the panel that conducted hearings on March 16 and 18.

According to the report, the jury unanimously found the Vice-Chancellor “guilty of all



charges” framed by the teachers' association and the students' union. It added that the evidence presented during the inquiry constituted sufficient grounds to formally demand her removal.

The organisations alleged that the functioning of the administration has undermined the university's foundational principles of social justice and democratic governance. They accused the Vice-Chan-

cellor of fostering corruption and caste-based discrimination, claiming that such practices have adversely affected the institutional environment.

They further contended that dissent within the campus has been curtailed through disciplinary actions, including the rustication of student representatives, multiple proctorial inquiries, and the filing of FIRs. These measures, they alleged, were used to deflect questions raised by students and faculty.

Describing the report as an attempt to ensure accountability, JNUTA and JNUSU said it aims to inform the wider academic community and the public about what they termed a systematic erosion of the university's inclusive character.

There was no immediate response from the university administration at the time of publication.

OPERATION CYBER HAWK 4.0

Over 600 held & 8,000 rounded up in crackdown on cybercrime

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested over 600 people and rounded up more than 8,300 suspects during its Operation CyHawk 4.0, a large-scale crackdown on cybercrime conducted on April 6 and 7, officials said on Wednesday.

A senior police officer said the son of a Delhi-based eatery chain owner is also among arrestees.

“Due to losses in business, the son of the famous eater chain's owner provided his bank account to move proceeds of cybercrime on a commission basis, where he received a three per cent commission. He shared his bank account user ID and password, and stolen or defrauded money was

“A total of 8,371 people were rounded up for questioning and verification during coordinated raids across multiple dists”

siphoned through that account. In this case, we have arrested Javed, and further investigation is ongoing,” Joint Commissioner of Police (IFSO) Rajneesh Gupta during a press conference said.

The officer said the operation targeted the financial backbone and operational ecosystem of organised cyber-crime syndicates operating across the capital, marking a shift from reactive policing to proactive dismantling of cyber fraud modules.

“A total of 8,371 people were rounded up for question-

ing and verification during coordinated raids carried out simultaneously across multiple districts. Out of these, 1,429 accused were either arrested or bound down after investigators established strong financial and technical linkages to cyber fraud activities,” the officer said.

In addition, 2,203 notices were issued to individuals suspected of being part of the backward financial chain associated with such crimes, he added.

Police said the operation led to the registration of 499 fresh FIRs against identi-

fied cyber fraudsters, significantly expanding the scope of legal action against organised networks.

Besides the new cases, investigators were able to make breakthroughs in 324 previously pending cyber fraud cases, with several accused apprehended after linking them to digital and financial evidence gathered during the operation.

Delhi Police targeted mule accounts, cash handlers and scam call centres in a cyber-crime crackdown, linking 3,564 NCRP complaints and tracing over Rs 519 crore to fraud networks. Raided recovered key digital evidence. The operation, backed by I4C after a month-long intelligence build-up, disrupted ongoing scams.

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police Cyber Cell has arrested a 26-year-old man in connection with a UPI fraud case linked to a mule account network during its special drive, “Cyber Hawk 4.0”.

The accused, identified as Parvez, a resident of Daryaganj, was apprehended after investigators traced the fraudulent transaction to a mule bank account used to receive the cheated amount.

The case came to light following a complaint lodged on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP), wherein the victim reported that Rs 23,800 was fraudulently debited from his account in two transactions around 2.21 pm on February 13. Of this, Rs 23,000 was transferred



to a bank account linked to the accused.

A case was registered at Daryaganj police station under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, and an investigation was initiated.

During scrutiny of cyber complaints and mule accounts under the Cyber Hawk 4.0 drive, police identified the suspicious account at Union Bank of India that had received the funds. A team tracked the

account holder and arrested Parvez on April 5.

During interrogation, the accused allegedly disclosed that he had provided his bank account to a relative to facilitate the transaction. Police said Rs 14,000 was subsequently transferred to the relative, while the remaining amount could not be moved after the account was flagged and frozen.

Verification through the Crime and Criminal Information System revealed that the accused is a habitual offender, allegedly involved in around 11 previous cases, including theft and snatching, registered at Kashmere Gate, Daryaganj and Hauz Qazi police stations.

Further investigation is underway to identify other members of the mule account network and trace additional linked cyber fraud transactions.

Surprise Check: GST officials face CM heat

No laxity, no excuses: ‘Discipline applies to all’



AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a strong message to Delhi’s bureaucracy, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday conducted a surprise inspection at the State GST office in ITO, uncovering widespread absenteeism, including among senior officials, and warning of strict action against negligence.

During the inspection, several officers were found missing from duty during working hours, prompting immediate directions for issuance of show-cause notices. Taking a firm stance, Gupta asserted, “Discipline is not meant only for junior staff; it applies equally to everyone, including commissioners and special commissioners,” making it clear that no official would be exempt from accountability.

The Chief Minister emphasized that her government would not tolerate inefficiency at any level and reiterated the compulsory implementation of biometric attendance. She directed departments to sub-

STRONG MESSAGE

- » Show-cause notices for absentee officers; biometric attendance mandatory for all
- » Officials to be held directly responsible for delays in public services, CM makes it clear
- » Surprise inspections will continue to ensure discipline and efficiency across departments: CM

mit attendance records for the past month without delay to fix responsibility. “No laxity will be tolerated when it comes to public service,” she said, underlining the administration’s zero-tolerance approach.

Interacting with taxpayers and visitors at the office, Gupta received multiple complaints regarding delays and unavailability of officials. Responding sharply, she warned, “If public

services are delayed, the concerned officers will be held directly accountable,” signaling stricter monitoring of service delivery timelines.

The inspection also highlighted infrastructural and safety lapses within the premises. Gupta ordered the immediate clearance of unused materials and stressed the need for regular fire safety audits. She further clarified that official meetings cannot be used as an excuse for delays in public work, directing departments to conduct weekly reviews of pending cases and streamline grievance redressal systems. Reaffirming her government’s stance, Gupta said Delhi is operating under a “zero-tolerance policy towards negligence, irregularities and corruption,” adding that surprise inspections will continue to ensure discipline and efficiency across departments.

The move is being seen as part of a broader push by the Delhi government to restore accountability and strengthen public trust in administrative functioning.

L-G and CM set Yamuna reset in motion

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major push to transform the Yamuna into a clean and vibrant public asset, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday carried out a joint inspection of Vasudev Ghat and Yamuna Bazar Ghat, reviewing progress on riverfront development, sanitation systems, and ecological restoration.

During the visit, the two leaders assessed infrastructure gaps, ongoing cleaning operations, and preparedness for monsoon and summer challenges. They noted a stark contrast between developed sites such as Vasudev Ghat and other stretches like Yamuna Bazar Ghat, emphasizing the need to replicate eco-friendly models across the riverfront.

Officials briefed them on



floodplain restoration work from Wazirabad to Okhla, including greenway development, plantation drives, wetland conservation, and biodiversity enhancement. Walking and cycling tracks, along with modern cleaning machinery deployment, were also reviewed as part

of the larger rejuvenation plan. Highlighting the urgency of the initiative, the L-G said, “Rejuvenation of Yamuna and addressing air pollution, water scarcity, and flooding are non-negotiable priorities,” adding that these efforts must be executed “in mission mode” with strict timelines. He also stressed that the inspection was based on extensive public feedback, with citizens raising concerns over pollution, flooding, and water shortages. Calling for coordinated action, Sandhu directed multiple agencies to work in close synergy and prepare time-bound implementation plans. He further noted that the project would benefit from collaboration with national and international experts, aligning with the Centre’s focus on Yamuna rejuvenation.

Reaffirming the Delhi government’s commitment, Chief Minister Gupta said, “Yamuna cleanliness is not merely a project but a firm commitment of the government.” She pointed out that a significant portion of the Rs 22,236 crore Green Budget has been earmarked for environmental initiatives, with the largest share

allocated to the Delhi Jal Board to strengthen sewage treatment and desilting operations.

Taking a firm stance on flood management, Gupta directed immediate removal of encroachments from floodplains to enhance the river’s water holding capacity. She also emphasized a three-pronged strategy focused on desilting, ensuring smooth water flow, and addressing waterlogging hotspots. The leaders further instructed officials to develop Yamuna ghats as a “continuous stretch” to create seamless public spaces, while maintaining ecological balance. Stressing strict monitoring, they called for zero tolerance against waste mismanagement and illegal dumping.

The joint inspection underscores a renewed push to restore the Yamuna as a sustainable, clean, and accessible riverfront for Delhi’s residents.

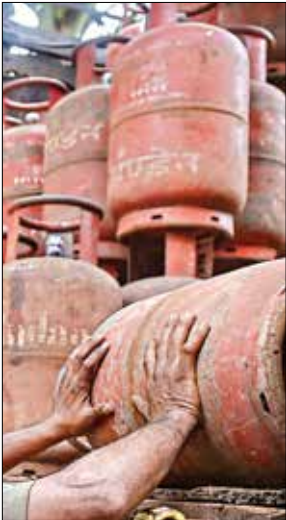
Govt to hold spl camps to help migrant workers procure LPG MCD plans surface parking REVAMP

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In an outreach push aimed at easing access to cooking fuel for migrant workers, the Delhi government announced on Wednesday that it will organise special camps across the city alongside an increase in the supply of small LPG cylinders.

The initiative follows the Centre’s decision to double the allocation of 5 kg Free Trade LPG (FTL) cylinders for migrant labourers. In line with this, the Delhi government has raised the daily availability from 684 to 1,368 cylinders, according to an official statement citing an order dated April 7.

“District magistrates have been directed to hold special camps in areas with a high con-



centration of migrant workers to ensure the increased supply reaches beneficiaries. Labourers facing difficulty in procur-

ing cylinders can approach the district magistrate’s office to request camps in their area,” the statement read.

Officials noted that camps will operate in coordination with oil marketing companies and authorised LPG distributors. Eligible workers will be able to obtain 5 kg cylinders at these camps upon payment and submission of their Aadhaar as identity proof.

District enforcement teams will assist in assessing demand and overseeing distribution to ensure transparency and smooth delivery, the statement added.

According to the statement, the outreach initiative is aimed at strengthening last-mile access and ensuring the timely availability of cooking fuel for migrant workers across Delhi.

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is planning a citywide revamp of surface parking lots across all 12 zones, with a focus on reducing pollution caused by dust, officials said.

Around 130 surface parking sites have been identified for redevelopment, they added.

The civic body’s engineering department will undertake the work, which will primarily involve laying interlocking paver blocks to prevent dust dispersion, an issue that intensifies during dry months and worsens air pollution levels.

“Key parking lots such as Ramliya Ground and the Kirti Nagar Timber Market are among the sites shortlisted,” an official said.

These open plot parkings often turn muddy during the monsoon and accumulate a lot of dust, which settles on vehicles and creates inconvenience for users.

A commuter said, “There was one instance when I parked my car at Ramliya Ground, and my shoes got extremely dirty. I had an important meeting that day and had to spend nearly one-and-a-half hours looking for a cobbler before heading to the office.”

Besides the infrastructure upgrade, the MCD has issued fresh directives to streamline parking operations. “Area inspectors have been strictly instructed to ensure that all contractors collecting parking fees wear uniforms,” an official said after complaints of overcharging at several parking sites.

He further explained that

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Around 130 surface parking sites have been identified for redevelopment
- » ‘Key parking lots such as Ramliya Ground and the Kirti Nagar Timber Market are among the sites shortlisted’
- » These open plot parkings often turn muddy during the monsoon and accumulate a lot of dust, which settles on vehicles and creates inconvenience for users

AAP alleges early end of MCD panel; Mayor says claim ‘baseless’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A political row broke out on Wednesday over the tenure of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s (MCD) standing committee, with the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) alleging its premature curtailment and Mayor Raja Iqbal Singh rejecting the claim as “baseless and misleading”.

Responding to the allegations, the Delhi mayor, in a statement, asserted that the claims were unfounded and said, “Allegations regarding the tenure of the Standing Committee are baseless and misleading,” while clarifying the legal context.

He pointed out that, according to the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act of 1957, 50 per cent of the members of the Standing Committee retire after one year.

“As per Section 45(3) of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 50 per cent of the members of the Standing Committee retire upon completion of one year,” he said.

In a press conference, the

AAP alleged that the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) had prematurely dissolved the MCD standing committee to “enable corruption” and demanded that it be allowed to continue its work until June 12 to prevent disruption in civic projects.

Earlier, addressing at the party headquarters, MCD co-incharge Praveen Kumar said the standing committee, whose term was to end on June 12, had been curtailed to March 31 through a proposal brought by the ruling party.

The mayor emphasised that the standing committee had neither been dissolved nor its operations impacted. He clarified that the committee consists of 18 members, with nine members retiring annually as per the established rules, followed by re-election through mayoral and ward committee elections.

Kumar had alleged that the BJP dissolved the standing committee in the MCD “three months in advance to carry out corruption worth crores of rupees.”

CM Shri school admissions from Apr 13

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Admissions to the CM Shri Schools in Delhi will open on April 13 for Classes 6 and 9, and on May 7 for Class 11 for the 2026–27 academic session, according to the Directorate of Education.

Admit cards were distributed on Wednesday for the entrance examinations. The tests for Classes 6 and 9 will be conducted in the last week of March, while the examination for Class 11 is scheduled for May, the DoE said in a public notice issued on Tuesday.

The results for Classes 6 and

9 will be announced on April 30, and the results for Class 11 will be released on May 25.

Only residents of Delhi who studied in a recognised school in the national capital during the 2025–26 academic session are eligible to apply, a circular issued by the education department stated.

According to the department, 50 per cent of the seats are reserved for students who have passed Classes 5, 8 and 10 from Delhi government schools. The remaining seats are open to other eligible applicants who meet the residency and schooling criteria.

The entrance examination will be objective and OMR-based. Class-wise syllabus details and a sample OMR sheet will be available on the department’s website to familiarise applicants with the format.

The question paper for Class 6 will be bilingual, while those for Classes 9 and 11 will be in English. There will be no negative marking for the Class 6 exam, but it will apply to the tests for Classes 9 and 11. The maximum marks for the Class 6 examination are 300, while the tests for Classes 9 and 11 will carry 400 marks each.

The CM Shri Schools, an initiative of the Delhi government, aim to provide education with modern infrastructure, updated curriculum and holistic learning practices.

The schools are part of efforts to strengthen public education and enhance academic and co-curricular opportunities for students.

On February 17, Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the programme across 75 government schools in the city and inaugurated a CM Shri school in Sarojini Nagar.

CAQM cracks down on 6 thermal power plants

NEW DELHI: The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) in NCR and adjoining areas has levied environmental compensation of over Rs 61 crore on six thermal power plants operational within a radius of 300 km in Delhi for non-compliance of bio-emission norms, according to officials.

The Environment (Utilisation of Crop Residue by Thermal Power Plants) Rules, 2023 mandate all coal-based thermal power plants to utilise a five per cent of biomass pellets or briquettes along with coal, with a minimum threshold of three per cent co-firing prescribed for FY 2024–25 to avoid imposition of environmental compensation. The statutory provisions were notified to promote ex-situ management of crop residue, reduce instances of paddy straw burning and mitigate air pollution in the NCR and adjoining areas. **MP05T**

City Briefs

BJP ARRESTING OUR WORKERS IN GUJARAT OUT OF FEAR: AAP

NEW DELHI: The BJP is arresting AAP workers in Gujarat because it is scared of the party’s expanding reach in the state, a party leader said on Wednesday. Anurag Dhanda, Aam Aadmi Party national media in-charge, said the BJP leaders have threatened the mother of Gopal Italia, AAP MLA from Gujarat, and the government there arrested several of the party’s members. “In the past few days, 160 Aam Aadmi Party workers have been arrested in Gujarat. Now they are planning to arrest Gopal Italia in a fake case. They are trying to intimidate him and his family,” Dhanda said.

DELHI TRIBUNAL AWARDS RS 2.72 CR TO MAN LEFT PARALYSED IN ROAD ACCIDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi Motor Accident Claims Tribunal (MACT) has awarded Rs 2.72 crore as compensation to a 19-year-old man left paralysed in a road accident in 2023. Presiding Officer Ruchika Singla was hearing a claim petition filed by the paralysed man, Khushwant Kapoor, against the driver of the offending vehicle, Harish Madan, its owner Mohan Lal Madan and its insurer.

TEMPERATURES LIKELY TO RISE FROM TODAY

Chill Sweep: Delhi records coldest April day in 11 years

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A blanket of clouds, gusty winds and spells of light, scattered rain through the day kept Delhi unusually cool for April, bringing down the maximum temperature to 28.2 degrees Celsius on Wednesday, the lowest for the month in 11 years, even as the city breathed easier after days with air quality settling in the ‘satisfactory’ category. The maximum temperature at Safdarjung was recorded at 28.2 degrees Celsius, 6.9 degrees below normal. The last time the maximum temperature was lower in April was on April 23, 2016, when it had settled at 27.2 degrees Celsius.

The city’s base weather station at Safdarjung recorded 6.4 mm of rainfall in the 24 hours

ending at 8.30 am today, marking the wettest spell since April 4, 2023, when 16.3 mm of rain was recorded. Between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, Palam recorded 0.6 mm of rainfall, Lodhi Road reported trace amounts, while Safdarjung, Ridge, and Ayanagar recorded no rainfall.

Meanwhile, Palam recorded 27.2 degrees Celsius, 8.3 degrees below normal. Lodhi Road recorded 28.0 degrees Celsius, 6.0 degrees below normal, Ridge 28.8 degrees Celsius, 6.3 degrees below normal, and Ayanagar 28.0 degrees Celsius, 6.9 degrees below normal.

The minimum temperature at Safdarjung settled at 16.8 degrees Celsius, 3.2 degrees below normal. Palam recorded 15.5 degrees Celsius, 4.5 degrees below normal, Lodhi

Road 16.2 degrees Celsius, 2.8 degrees below normal, Ridge 15.3 degrees Celsius, 4.8 degrees below normal, and Ayanagar 16.4 degrees Celsius, 2.5 degrees below normal.

“The main weather activity is with respect to the western disturbance, which is currently seen over north Punjab and adjoining Jammu and Kashmir, which is likely to cause thunderstorm and precipitation activity over northwest parts of the country,” IMD scientist Dr Akhil Srivastava said.

He added that temperatures are expected to rise from Wednesday. “After tomorrow, we are expecting a rise in the maximum temperatures over the northwest parts of the country by 6 to 8 degrees Celsius...,” he said.

AIIMS stresses scientific approach to healthcare

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Marking World Health Day, the All India Institute of Medical Sciences emphasised the role of science-based healthcare and collaborative research in strengthening the country’s public health system.

Addressing to ANI, Director M. Srinivas noted that this year’s theme, “Together for Health, Stand with Science,” highlights the need for collective efforts in advancing medical research and improving healthcare delivery. He underlined the importance of work-

ing in unison to ensure better outcomes for patients.

The premier medical institution continues to play a crucial role in providing accessible and affordable healthcare services, catering to a large number of patients from across the country. Its contribution to medical education and specialised treatment remains significant.

Dr. Srinivas also pointed to the growing importance of integrating digital health systems and expanding medical infrastructure to meet rising healthcare demands.

MCD to mount over 4L ‘smart’ STREETLIGHTS

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Over four lakh “smart” streetlights are set to be installed across the national capital in the coming months by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), officials said.

The largely LED-based lights, equipped with remote monitoring systems, will be rolled out in the central, south, Najafgarh and west zones, they said. Unlike conventional fixtures, the smart lights will be connected to a centralised control system, allowing authorities to track performance, detect faults in real time and carry out maintenance more quickly, they added.

The system will also generate data on energy consumption and network functioning, helping streamline operations and reduce electricity usage, the officials said.

The move is likely to improve illumination across neighbourhoods, with better-lit streets seen as a factor in enhancing safety and supporting night-time economic activity, they said.

The transition will take place gradually over the coming months, with neighbourhoods upgraded one by one as the new lights are brighter, they added.

Civic body officials said that similar maintenance and repair works were carried out in recent months to address outages and improve response times. **AGENCIES**

REQUEST RAISED IN RAHMAN-JAISHANKAR TALKS

Bangladesh reiterates its request for extradition of Sheikh Hasina

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Bangladesh has reiterated its request to India to extradite ousted Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina and her Home Minister Asaduzaman Khan Kamal to Bangladesh who have been awarded the death penalty by the International Crimes Tribunal.

The request was made during discussions between Bangladesh Foreign Minister Dr Khalilur Rahman and External Affairs Minister Dr S Jaishankar here on Wednesday, according to a release by the Bangladesh High Commission. Adviser on Foreign Affairs to Prime Minister of Bangladesh, Humayun Kabir was also present at the meeting.

Dr Jaishankar reiterated India's desire to engage constructively with the new Gov-



ernment and further strengthen bilateral ties. The two sides agreed to explore proposals for deepening the partnership through the relevant bilateral mechanisms. Follow-on official meetings are expected to take place at an early date. Further, both sides exchanged views on

regional and global issues of mutual interest, according to a statement by the Ministry of External Affairs.

During the visit, Foreign Minister Rahman also met the National Security Adviser, Ajit Doval and Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep

HIGHLIGHTS

» Jaishankar reiterated India's desire to engage constructively with the new Government and further strengthen bilateral ties

» The two sides agreed to explore proposals for deepening the partnership through the relevant bilateral mechanisms

Singh Puri.

Dr Rahman stated that the recently elected BNP government under the leadership of Prime Minister Tarique Rahman would pursue its foreign policy in accordance with the principle of ``Bangladesh First'' and on the basis of mutual

trust and respect and reciprocal benefit. The visiting Foreign Minister thanked the Indian government for apprehending the suspected killers of Shaheed Osman Hadi. Both sides agreed that the arrested persons will be returned to Bangladesh in accordance with the procedures laid out in the extradition treaty between the two countries. During the discussion, Dr Jaishankar said Indian visas to Bangladeshis, particularly medical and business visas, would be eased in the coming weeks.

Dr Rahman also thanked Minister Hardeep Puri for the recent supply of diesel to Bangladesh by India and requested to increase the volume of supply of diesel and fertilizer.

Minister Puri indicated that the government would consider the request readily and favourably.

BJP leader's father, SC lawyer & Amit Shah's host, among lakhs struck off voter roll

Continued from Page 1

Calling the development "deeply disappointing".

Concerns have also been raised by the legal fraternity. Supreme Court lawyer Gaurav Ghosh alleged that his name was deleted despite submitting valid documents, claiming he was "not given a proper chance to present his case," and termed the process a violation of natural justice.

Among others affected is para-athlete Atar Ali from Ranaghat, who has won a gold medal for the country, but alleged that his name was deleted from the voter list ahead of the 2026 Assembly polls. He claimed that despite multiple appeals, including approaching administrative officials, no resolution was reached. Recounting his experience, Ali said

he had to wait for hours to meet officials and was asked by the district magistrate, "When did your family come from Bangladesh?," a question that left him shocked and has since triggered fresh controversy.

BJP leader Anirban Ganguly alleged that his father, Ashok Kumar Ganguly, a voter for over four decades, had his name deleted during the revision exercise.

The name of the 88-year-old grandson of Nandalal Bose was removed from the rolls. In response, the Supreme Court of India directed him to approach the Appellate Tribunal for relief and asked for an expeditious hearing of the matter.

With multiple allegations surfacing from diverse quarters, the SIR process has become a major political

flashpoint in the run-up to the elections, even as officials maintain that due procedure is being followed.

Meanwhile, Bhowanipore, the South Kolkata Constituency represented by TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee, has seen a further surge in voter deletions following the resolution of pending cases.

Reportedly, of the 14,154 names under review, judicial officers appointed by the Calcutta High Court adjudicated the matters, resulting in the removal of approximately 3,500 additional voters. Previously, 47,112 names had already been excluded in the draft and final electoral rolls. With the latest adjudication, the total number of deletions in Bhowanipore now stands at 50,612.

From Page 1

US-Iran 2-week

The team will consist of Vice-President JD Vance, Trump adviser Steve Witkoff, and Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner. The talks will begin on Saturday morning local time, she said, adding: "We look forward to those in-person meetings."

Earlier, Israel bombed locations across Lebanon, including the capital Beirut, in devastating attacks that authorities say have killed at least 254 people and wounded over 1,165.

Iran, the United States and Israel agreed to a two-week ceasefire in an 11th-hour deal that headed off US President Donald Trump's threat to unleash a bombing campaign to destroy Iranian civilization. But hours after the announcement, Iran and Gulf Arab countries reported new attacks on Wednesday.

It was not clear if the strikes would scuttle the deal, which US Vice President JD Vance called "fragile".

However, for now, both the US and Iran have claimed victory, and world leaders have expressed relief.

Even before the new attacks, much about the agreement was unclear as the sides presented vastly different visions of the terms.

Iran said the deal would allow it to formalise its new practice of charging ships passing through the Strait of Hormuz, a crucial transit lane for oil. But the details were not clear, nor was it known whether vessels would feel safe using the channel or whether ship traffic had resumed. It also was unclear whether any other country agreed to this condition.

Iran's ability to control the Strait of Hormuz proved a tremendous strategic advantage.

Iranian attacks and threats deterred many commercial ships from passing through the waterway, through which 20 per cent of all traded oil and natural gas passes in peacetime. That roiled the world economy and raised the pressure on Trump both at home and abroad to find a way out of the standoff.

The ceasefire may formalise a system of charging fees in the strait that Iran instituted — and give it a new source of revenue.

The plan allows for both Iran and Oman to charge ships, according to a regional official who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss negotiations they were directly involved in. The official said Iran would use the money it raised for reconstruction.

That would upend decades of precedent treating the strait as an international waterway that was free to transit and will likely not be acceptable to the Gulf Arab states, which also need to rebuild after repeated Iranian attacks targeting their oil fields.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said passage through the strait would be allowed under Iranian military management — further clouding the picture of who would be allowed to transit the waterway.

Trump said the US has received a 10-point proposal from Iran, which he called a "workable basis on which to negotiate".

"Almost all of the various points of past contention have been agreed to between the United States and Iran, but a two-week period will allow the Agreement to be finalised and consummated," he said on his social media platform Truth Social.

News of the ceasefire sent stock markets surging worldwide, and oil prices plunged back toward USD 90 per barrel.

Pakistan, which helped to mediate the deal, and others said fighting would pause in Lebanon, where Israel has launched a ground invasion against the Iran-backed Hezbollah militant group. Israel said it would not, and strikes hit Beirut on Wednesday.

The fate of Iran's missile and nuclear programs — the elimination of which were major objectives for the US and Israel in going to war — also remained unclear. Trump said the US would work with Iran to remove buried enriched uranium, though Iran did not confirm that.

Iran's demands for ending the war include a withdrawal of US combat forces from the region, the lifting of sanctions, and the release of its frozen assets.

In his post on Wednesday, Trump said, "We are, and will be, talking Tariff and Sanctions relief with Iran."

Pakistan said talks to hammer out a permanent end to the war could begin in Islamabad as soon as Saturday.

Israel backed the US ceasefire with Iran, but Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the deal does not cover fighting against Hezbollah.

The Israeli military said it struck more than 100 targets within 10 minutes Wednesday across Lebanon, the largest wave of strikes since March 1.

News of the ceasefire sent stock markets surging worldwide, and oil prices plunged back toward USD 90 per barrel.

US-Israeli strikes have battered Iran and its leadership, but they have not entirely eliminated the threats posed by Tehran's nuclear programme, its ballistic missiles or its support for regional proxies, like Hezbollah.

The US and Israel said addressing those threats was a key justification for going to war.

Trump said Wednesday that the US would work with Iran to "dig up and remove" enriched uranium that was buried under joint US-Israeli strikes in June. He added that none of the material had been touched since. Any retrieval is expected to be an intensive undertaking.

There was no confirmation from Iran on that.

Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth told a Pentagon briefing Wednesday that the US would do "something like" last June's joint strikes with Israel on Iranian nuclear sites if the country refuses to surrender its enriched uranium voluntarily.

Tehran insisted for years that its nuclear program was peaceful, although it enriched uranium up to 60 per cent purity, a short, technical step from weapons-grade levels.

Hegseth said the US military has done its part "for now" but stands ready to ensure Iran complies with all the ceasefire's terms.

Gen. Dan Caine, chairman of the US Joint Chiefs of Staff, said more than 13,000 targets have been struck in Iran, destroying 80 per cent of the country's air defence systems and attacking 90 per cent of its weapons factories.

More than 90 per cent of Iran's

regular naval fleet has been sunk, "including all major surface combatants" with 150 ships now "at the bottom of the ocean", Caine told reporters at a Pentagon briefing.

Shortly after the ceasefire announcement, Bahrain, Israel, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates all issued warnings about incoming missiles from Iran. That fire stopped for a time, then hostilities appeared to restart.

India hopes

"We welcome all steps that lead to peace and stability," Jaiswal said.

The government reiterated that the safety of Indian nationals in the region remains its top priority. According to official figures, around 7,500 Indians are still in Iran. As of Tuesday, 1,864 citizens, including 935 students and 472 fishermen, had exited via Armenia and Azerbaijan.

Jaiswal said India is closely monitoring shipping through the Strait and remains in contact with Iran and other stakeholders to ensure smooth transit. He added that several Indian vessels have already crossed the passage and clarified that there have been no discussions with Iran regarding any transit fee, amid such reports.

EC-TMC meet

"We gave him six examples of officials who are part of the election process and have links with the BJP" O'Brien said. Among the examples cited was that of the Chief Electoral Officer being accompanied by a local BJP leader in Nandigram. A memorandum was submitted in this regard, he said.

"We asked the CEC how he can ensure the conduct of free and fair elections when such tainted officers are being appointed in Bengal. To this, his answer was 'Get lost,' said O'Brien. "We told the CEC we would not listen to him because he does not allow his colleagues to speak. We have attended eight to nine meetings like this, where none other than the CEC speaks," O'Brien said. He also said that they congratulated Gyanesh Kumar on being the first CEC in history to have notices seeking his removal submitted in Parliament.

On social media handles also the TMC and ECI engaged in a war of words after the poll body claimed to have given an "ultimatum" to the ruling party in Bengal. The poll body on X handle writes: "Election Commission's Ultimatum to Trinamool Congress Elections in West Bengal this time: Fear-free, Violence-free, Intimidation-free, Inducement-free, Raid-free, Booth and Source Jamming-free will they surely be ECI's Straight-talk to Trinamool Congress This time, the Elections in West Bengal would surely be: Fear-free, Violence-free, Intimidation-free, Inducement-free and without any Raid, Booth Jamming and Source Jamming."

The TMC issued a strong response saying: "We are also speaking to the Election Commission in a straightforward manner. This time, the elections must be: Free from Delhi's control, Free from political bias, Free from targeted persecution of anyone, And certainly free from double standards."

TMC spokesperson Saket Gokhale took to X to deny the

ECI's claim about its "ultimatum" to the TMC. "This is a LIE. I was personally present at the meeting. NOTHING like this was said. All that CEC Gyanesh Kumar said to us was 'GET LOST'." "We challenge the ECI to release a transcript of the meeting. Else we will do it," Saket Gokhale posted on X.

Govt raises P&K fertiliser

The decision was taken at a meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, with revised subsidy rates set to be effective from April 1 to September 30, 2026. Under the updated rates, subsidy for nitrogen has been fixed at Rs 47.32 per kg, up from Rs 43.02 per kg in the previous season. Phosphate subsidy has been increased to Rs 52.76 per kg from Rs 47.96 per kg, while sulphur will receive Rs 3.16 per kg compared to Rs 2.87 per kg earlier. The subsidy for potash remains unchanged at Rs 2.38 per kg.

Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the increase amounts to an additional Rs 4,317 crore over the Kharif 2025 season. He noted that despite a surge in global prices of Di-ammonium Phosphate since the Covid period, the retail price has been maintained at Rs 1,350 per 50 kg bag for farmers.

The subsidy applies to 28 grades of fertilisers under the Nutrient Based Subsidy scheme, which has been in place since April 2010. Additional measures approved by the Cabinet include steps to manage global price volatility, extending safeguards to imported Triple Super Phosphate, continuing freight subsidy for Single Super Phosphate, and including both imported and domestically produced Ammonium Sulphate under the scheme.

Kharif sowing typically begins with the onset of the southwest monsoon in June. For the financial year 2026-27, the total allocation for NBS and urea subsidies has been set at Rs 1,70,799 crore. Retail prices of non-urea fertilisers remain decontrolled, with manufacturers determining rates while receiving fixed subsidies from the government.

RBI holds

in the previous year. Inflation is projected at 4.6 per cent for 2026-27, within the mandated 2 to 6 per cent band, while core inflation is estimated at 4.4 per cent. For the first 11 months of 2025-26, average inflation stood at 1.95 per cent.

Malhotra said the ceasefire between the US and Iran, announced early Wednesday, was "pleasant news" and had been factored into the policy decision. However, he cautioned that the full implications of the conflict, particularly on energy costs and supply chains, would unfold over time. The hostilities, which lasted over a month, led to disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz, a key artery for global energy supplies, significantly affecting countries like India that depend heavily on the region for crude oil and cooking gas.

Crude prices surged past USD 100 per barrel during the conflict, increasing India's import bill and contributing to a roughly 7 per cent depreciation of the rupee over the past year. Although the currency showed some recov-

ery, appreciating 50 paise to 92.56 against the US dollar in early trade on Wednesday, Malhotra acknowledged that the depreciation has compounded imported inflation pressures.

"Elevated energy and other commodity prices, along with disruptions in availability of inputs, are likely to impact growth," he said, adding that higher freight and insurance costs, as well as supply chain constraints, could weigh on industrial and agricultural output.

Despite these risks, the governor expressed confidence in the resilience of the Indian economy, pointing to strong macroeconomic fundamentals and continued support from private consumption and investment demand. "Structurally, long-term macroeconomic fundamentals remain very strong and continue to drive growth while keeping price pressures contained," he said.

Malhotra also indicated that interest rates could remain low over the medium to long term if inflation conditions stay benign. "We are in a neutral state... the possibility either way cannot be ruled out, but it is quite possible that even in the short to medium term, we will continue to have low rates," he said.

The central bank has reduced the repo rate by a cumulative 125 basis points since February last year, including a 25-basis-point cut in December. According to Malhotra, banks have transmitted about 90 basis points of this reduction to lending rates and over 100 basis points to deposit rates, indicating satisfactory policy transmission.

On financial stability, he said the RBI does not see any systemic risk to asset quality or significant impact on credit growth from the geopolitical tensions. Measures taken recently to curb volatility in the foreign exchange market were described as temporary steps aimed at stabilising the rupee rather than structural changes.

Reiterating the RBI's exchange rate policy, Malhotra said interventions are limited to smoothing excessive volatility without targeting any specific level. "We would judiciously contain excessive or disruptive volatility to ensure that currency movements remain aligned with fundamentals," he said.

He also pointed to broader lessons from the crisis, calling for structural changes such as accelerating the adoption of electric vehicles and improving domestic energy self-sufficiency to reduce dependence on imports.

Constitutional

standalone ground for judicial review. He told the court that earlier rulings which relied on this doctrine, including the 2018 judgments decriminalising consensual same-sex relations and striking down the adultery law, were "not a good law" insofar as they invoked constitutional morality as a test.

Mehta submitted that constitutional morality is rooted in political theory and relates to how constitutional functionaries ought to act, rather than providing a judicial standard to evaluate legislation or religious customs.

"Judicial review has to be exercised as per the Constitution," he said, adding that courts may intervene only when a practice violates public order, health or morality as contemplated under Articles 25 and

26. The Centre's arguments were made in the context of the 2018 Sabarimala verdict, in which a five-judge Bench, by a 4:1 majority, allowed women of all age groups to enter the Kerala temple, setting aside a long-standing restriction on women between 10 and 50 years of age. Mehta said the reasoning in that judgment, which invoked constitutional morality over what it termed "societal morality", was flawed and had relied on a doctrine that lacks clear definition.

He further criticised the use of foreign academic writings and legal scholarship in constitutional adjudication, pointing to references in the adultery judgment to works by Western scholars. A binding law affecting over a billion citizens, he argued, should not be based on "individual and subjective views" drawn from foreign journals or selective academic commentary. Chief Justice Kant also questioned the reliance on foreign experts, remarking on the prominence given to certain American scholars in past rulings.

At the same time, members of the Bench raised questions about the scope of judicial intervention. Justice Nagarathna observed that the adultery provision could have been invalidated on grounds of equality under Article 14 without invoking constitutional morality. Chief Justice Kant noted that the adultery law had been rightly struck down as discriminatory, since it penalised only men.

The hearing also saw a broader debate on whether secular courts can determine if a religious practice is irrational or superstitious. Mehta maintained that courts lack the "scholarly competence" to adjudicate religious doctrines and should not sit in appeal over the attributes of deities or the validity of beliefs. Referring to Lord Ayyappa, he said the deity is regarded as a "Naishtika Brahmachari" and practices associated with that belief cannot be subjected to judicial scrutiny on rationality grounds.

"If religion does not interfere with the State, the State must also not interfere with religion," Mehta argued, adding that reforms should originate within the community or through legislation enacted under Article 25(2)(b). He cited laws dealing with practices such as black magic as examples of legislative intervention.

However, the bench indicated that the court's jurisdiction cannot be entirely excluded. Justice Amanullah remarked that while the legislature may ultimately frame policy, the court retains the power of judicial review. Justice Sundresh said that in cases involving practices that are manifestly harmful or unconstitutional, courts cannot adopt a completely "hands-off" approach. Chief Justice Kant observed that practices such as human sacrifice or cannibalism would clearly fall foul of public order, morality or health and could be struck down without elaborate analysis.

Justice Bagchi raised a hypothetical involving witchcraft, asking whether the court could intervene in the absence of legislation. The Chief Justice responded that in cases that "shock the conscience", the court could act within the framework of constitutional limitations.

Another key issue before the bench is the "essential religious practices" test, which has been used by courts to determine which practices are protected under the Constitution. Mehta argued that applying this test is particularly

difficult in the context of Hinduism, which he described as internally diverse and lacking a single founder, scripture or unified doctrine. This plurality, he said, makes it "impossible" at times to conclusively identify what is essential, leading to arbitrary outcomes.

The Solicitor General also highlighted competing rights under Articles 25 and 26, contending that the rights of devotees who adhere to specific religious tenets must be balanced against claims by individuals seeking entry into places of worship. "My right as a follower must also be considered," he said, referring to the Sabarimala dispute.

The Bench, meanwhile, examined the broader constitutional questions arising from the reference, including the extent of religious freedom, whether denominational rights are subject to other fundamental rights, and the meaning of "morality" in Articles 25 and 26. One of the issues under consideration is whether constitutional morality forms part of that expression.

During the hearing, judges also discussed the nature of religious denominations and whether philosophical movements can qualify as such. Justice Nagarathna questioned whether certain belief systems could be treated as religious denominations, while the Chief Justice explained that what matters is the belief of followers who treat a philosophy as their guiding faith.

The proceedings stem from a 2019 order in which a five-judge bench referred larger questions arising from the Sabarimala review petitions to a nine-judge bench. The court had then left the issue of women's entry unresolved while seeking authoritative answers on constitutional principles that affect multiple faiths and practices. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

India withdraws

The hosting of COP summits rotates among the UN's five regional groups. COP31 this year will be co-hosted by Türkiye and Australia, representing the Western Europe and Others Group, while next year's session is set to take place in Ethiopia under the African Group.

In July 2025, India's Environment Ministry had established a dedicated COP33 Cell to manage logistical and professional requirements for the proposed event.

The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change oversees the annual negotiations. MPPOST

Khera moves Telangana

The case stems from Khera's April 5 claim that Riniki Bhuyan Sarma held multiple passports and foreign assets not disclosed in election filings, which the family dismissed as "false" and "malicious".

Police registered a case under BNS provisions including false election statements and cheating. Officers who visited his Delhi residence reported finding "incriminating" material.

Sarma accused Khera of evading questioning, while Khera said he was being targeted instead of receiving answers. Assam votes on Thursday. MPPOST

BJP AIMS HAT-TRICK, CONG EYES WRESTING POWER

Assam to vote in high-stakes polls today

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GUWAHATI: The high-stakes elections to the 126-member Assam Assembly will be held on Thursday, with most seats slated to witness a direct contest between the BJP-led NDA and the Opposition coalition helmed by the Congress.

The BJP is eyeing a third straight term in power in these elections, while the Congress is looking to wrest the state, from where it was ousted in 2016.

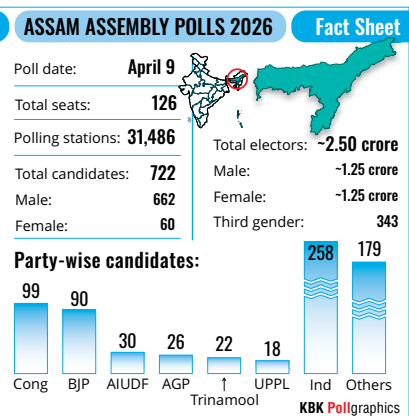
A total of 722 candidates, including Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, state Congress president Gaurav Gogoi, Leader of Opposition Debabrata Saikia, AIUDF chief Badruddin Ajmal, Rajjor Dal leader Akhil Gogoi, and BJP president Lurinjyoti Gogoi, are in the fray.

Polling will be held from 7 am to 5 pm across 31,490 polling stations in 35 districts. A total of 2.50 crore people, including 1.25 crore women and 318 from the third gender, are eligible to vote.

Among political parties, the Congress has fielded the highest number of candidates at 99,



Polling officials collect EVMs, VVPATs and other election materials from a distribution centre on the eve of Assam Assembly Election, in Nagaon district, Wednesday



followed by the BJP with 90. The AIUDF has 30 candidates, while NDA constituents Asom Gana Parishad (AGP) and Bodoland People's Front (BPF) are contesting 26 and 11 seats, respectively.

In the Opposition Bloc, Rajjor Dal is contesting 13 seats, Assam Jatiya Parishad (AJP) 10, CPI(M) 3 and APHLC 2. Other parties in the fray include AAP (18), UPPL (18), TMC (22), JMM (16), besides 258 Independents.

Alagpur-Katlicherra and Karimganj South have the highest number of candidates at 15

each, while nine constituencies -- Rangia, Jagiroad (SC), Hojai, Naduar, Jonai (ST), Doomdooma, Mahmora, Teok and Lakhipur -- have only two candidates each.

Of the total contestants, 59 are women, with the Congress fielding the highest number at 14, followed by the BJP with seven. Other parties have given limited representation to women, while none of the candidates identifies as third gender.

Key contests include Jalukbari, where Sarma is seeking a sixth consecutive term against

Congress's Bidisha Neog, and Jorhat, where Gaurav Gogoi is seeking to make his Assembly debut against BJP's Hitendranath Goswami.

In Nazira, Debabrata Saikia is attempting to retain his family stronghold against BJP's Mayur Borgohain. The Tamulpur seat in the Bodoland Territorial Region will witness a direct fight between Daimary and UPPL chief Pramod Boro.

AIUDF chief Badruddin Ajmal is contesting from Binnakandi in a triangular contest against AGP's Shahabuddin

Mazumdar and AJP's Rejaul Karim Chowdhury.

In Sibsagar, Akhil Gogoi faces a three-cornered contest against BJP's Jayanta Hazarika and AGP's Pradip Hazarika.

AJP's Lurinjyoti Gogoi is in a direct fight with BJP's Chakradhar Gogoi in Khowang, while AGP president and minister Atul Bora faces a triangular contest against Rajjor Dal's Hari Prasad Saikia and former Independent MLA Jiten Gogoi in the Bokakhat constituency.

Minister Keshav Mahanta is locked in a direct contest in Kaliabor against Rajjor Dal candidate Pradip Kumar Baruah.

Chief Electoral Officer Anurag Goel said webcasting facilities have been enabled at all polling stations for real-time monitoring.

Central Armed Police Forces, including CRPF personnel, have been deployed to ensure security.

The electorate includes 6.42 lakh first-time voters, 2.50 lakh voters aged 80 and above, including 2,466 centenarians, and 2.05 lakh persons with disabilities.

Kerala polls: LDF eyes hat-trick, UDF comeback & NDA entry

Southern state will go to polls in a single phase today

OUR CORRESPONDENT

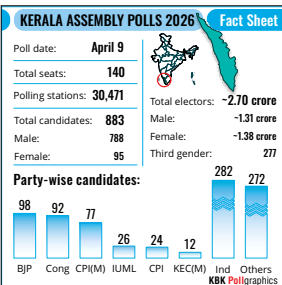
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM:

Kerala is all set for a crucial Assembly election on Thursday, with 2.71 crore voters poised to cast their franchise in a decisive contest that will test the ruling LDF's bid for a third consecutive term, the Opposition UDF's comeback prospects, and the NDA's push to open its account in the state.

After nearly a month of intense campaigning, the southern state will go to the polls in a single phase, with voting to be held from 7 am to 6 pm across all 140 constituencies where 883 candidates are in the fray.

The electorate comprises 1.32 crore men, 1.39 crore women and 273 transgender persons, along with over 2.42 lakh overseas voters, underlining the scale of the electoral exercise, according to Election Commission figures.

The contest, though triangular, is rooted in Kerala's traditionally bipolar political landscape, where power has largely alternated



between the LDF and the UDF. The outcome of this election will indicate whether that pattern holds or if the state is headed towards a shift.

For the CPI(M)-led ruling LDF, the polls are a high-stakes battle to retain power for a third straight term--an outcome that would be politically significant in a state known for voting out incumbent governments.

Led by Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, the Left Front has foregrounded its 10-year governance record, highlighting infrastructure development, welfare schemes and crisis management. However, the LDF faces challenges, including talks of anti-incumbency and questions raised after setbacks in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls and recent local body elections.

The Left front has sought to counter these by projecting continuity, stability and delivery, while rejecting Opposition charges of corruption and misgovernance. Meanwhile, the Congress-led UDF sees the election as a major opportunity to return to power, banking on Kerala's alternating voting trend and what it describes as growing public dissatisfaction with the incumbent government. It has built its campaign around issues of governance, alleged corruption and the style of functioning of the Vijayan administration. The UDF has also attempted to sharpen its political messaging by alleging an understanding between the CPI(M) and the BJP, while accusing the Left of links with outfits like the SDPI, the political arm of the banned Islamist outfit Popular Front of India (PFI).

Puducherry: 9.50 lakh voters to decide fate of 294 candidates

All arrangements in place, says CEO

OUR CORRESPONDENT

PUDUCHERRY: Around 9.50 lakh voters will decide the electoral fate of 294 candidates in the Assembly elections in Puducherry on April 9 and all arrangements have been made for smooth conduct of polls, CEO P Jawahar said here on Wednesday.

The polling will begin at 7 am in Puducherry and its enclaves of Karaikal, Mahe and Yanam which together have 30 Assembly seats.

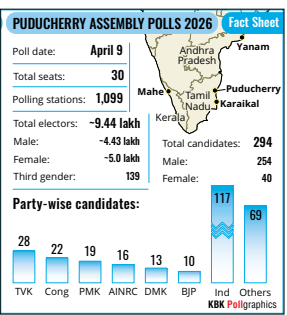
The union territory has 1,099 polling stations and of them 209 have been identified as vulnerable, Jawahar told media here.

Thirty polling stations would be managed exclusively by women staff and 15 booths would be operated by young officers. Two polling stations would be operated by persons with disabilities, he added.

The union territory has as many as 24,919 new voters, he said.

The Chief Electoral Officer said senior citizens and differently-abled voters would be assisted by volunteers at the booths to reach the polling stations to cast their votes and also for their safe return to their homes. Wheelchairs will be available. The election authorities have engaged 2,200 young voters to take care of them, he said.

Jawahar said that deployment of drones for monitoring purposes had been of help to track persons indulging in activities that tarnished fair poll. He said cash and liquor were seized after drone surveillance was conducted. A total of Rs 77.25 lakh was seized at various points and liquor worth Rs 68.50 lakh was also seized.



Seventeen cases were booked for alleged violation of the Model Code of Conduct during the past few weeks. As many as 24 persons were booked for allegedly distributing cash to lure the voters, he said.

Besides major political parties, newly floated parties are also in the fray. The NDA comprising AINRC, BJP, AIADMK and LJK faces a challenge from the INDIA Bloc comprising the Congress, DMK and the VCK.

While the NDA is fighting to retain its 'double engine' governance, the Opposition Bloc is making a push to regain power in the union territory, focusing on issues of local autonomy and administrative friction. Actor Vijay's newly formed TVK has emerged as a significant third force fielding candidates across the union territory.

'Special Intensive Revision in Bengal is organised disenfranchisement'

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in West Bengal is not electoral housekeeping, it is organised disenfranchisement, said Swaraj India leader Yogendra Yadav at a press conference organised by Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan and Desh Bachao Ganomancho on Wednesday.

Yadav stated that as of October 27, 2025, West Bengal had 7.66 crore registered voters against 7.67 crore adults, an Elector-Population ratio of 99.67 per cent. "There was no problem in the West Bengal voter list before SIR. It was among the most credible in the country," he said.

The SIR, he argued, shifted the burden of proof onto existing voters, effectively overturning the presumption of citizenship.

The numbers that followed were stark. Across all SIR states, total voters fell from 50.72 crore pre-SIR to 45.29 crore at the final roll, a deletion of 5.44 crore. West Bengal alone saw 90.8

lakh deletions. The adjudication process resulted in an additional 27 lakh deletions at an unusually high rate of 45 per cent. The pattern was not random, he said. Districts with strong TMC performance showed the heaviest deletions. Minority-concentrated areas saw "excessive Muslim deletions", and so was Nandigram, he said. In Malda, 83 per cent of voter entries were flagged for adjudication, while the pass rate was only 71 per cent.

The TMC-BJP gap was 9.8 per cent in 2021, narrowing to 7.1 per cent in 2024.

Unusual deletions of five per cent in 2026 put between 19 and 25 seats in the critical category, with up to 70 seats becoming vulnerable.

Advocate Prashant Bhushan raised the structural question. "The logical discrepancy criteria are designed so that Muslims will be the ones flagged. This is not an administrative error," he said, adding that the Supreme Court's own recommendation of a neutral three-member panel for appointing Election Commissioners had been quietly buried.

Drone Didi Yojana

Under the **Namo** Drone Didi Yojana

- * Training to women for operating drones along with free drone facility
- * Provision of subsidy as per eligibility and norms

Non-Stop Haryana

Under the Drone Didi Yojana, the State Government will provide 80% subsidy on the cost of drones and accessories or up to a maximum of ₹8 lakh to 5000 women

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FRESH VIOLENCE LEFT FOUR DEAD IN BISHNUPUR

Manipur CM chairs Unified Command meet to review law & order

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IMPHAL: Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh on Wednesday chaired a Unified Command meeting to review the prevailing law and order situation in the state, a day after fresh violence left four persons dead in Bishnupur district, officials said.

In a post on X, Singh said, “Chaired a Combined Headquarters Security (Unified Command) Meeting today at the Secretariat, attended by Hon’ble Home Minister Shri K. Govindas, the Chief Secretary, Security Adviser, DGP, and senior officials from the Army, Assam Rifles, CRPF, BSF, ITBP, and SSB.”

“The meeting undertook a comprehensive review of the prevailing law and order situation and associated security concerns. Measures, in accordance with constitutional provisions, were deliberated in detail to effectively respond to the current challenges and to ensure the restoration and maintenance of peace, stability, and public safety,” the CM said.

Singh added, “The government remains firmly committed to taking all necessary steps to safeguard the lives and interests of the people and to uphold law and order across the state.”

The meeting came a day after two children were killed in a bomb attack at Moirang Tronglaobi on Tuesday, while two others died when a mob stormed a CRPF camp during protests against the blast, police said. Soon after the bomb attack, Singh termed it a “barbaric act” and “an outright assault on humanity and a direct attempt to derail the hard-earned peace

First phase of PM-KUSUM scheme failed to meet targets: Report

NEW DELHI: The first phase of the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha & Uththan Mahabhiyan (PM-KUSUM) scheme, which ended on March 31, fell short of meeting its targets, according to a new report.

Launched in 2019, the PM-KUSUM scheme is India's flagship programme to promote solar energy in agriculture.

The analysis, ‘Scaling Solar Power for Irrigation in India: Lessons from PM-KUSUM’, was published on Wednesday by the Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW), the Center for Study of Science, Technology and Policy (CSTEP), and the International Institute for Sustainable Development (IISD).

The analysis focused on the scheme's Component A (setting up small-scale grid-connected solar plants on farmers' land) and Component C-FLS (feeder-level solarisation of existing grid-connected agriculture pumps).

The report revealed that deployment under Component A stood at just 8.4 per cent of the target, which was 10,000 MW.

In case of Component C-FLS, only 38.2 per cent of the 35.6 lakh pumps sanctioned were solarised, according to the report.

While the aim of Component A was to help farmers earn additional income, Component C-FLS sought to support DISCOM in solarising its agricultural feeders to reduce the burden of providing agricultural electricity subsidies.

The report states that progress had been stalled by low farmer awareness, land availability constraints, tariff viability challenges, grid limitations, and broader institutional and financial bottlenecks.

In a statement, Anas Rahman, senior policy advisor at the IISD, said, “As the scheme enters its next phase, states should focus on tariff design, grid readiness, and payment security to make solar irrigation financially sustainable for both utilities and farmers.”



People stage a protest under the banner of Coordinating Committee on Manipur Integrity (COCOMI), following a bomb attack in Bishnupur leaving two children dead, Manipur, Wednesday

Manipur: Death toll in firing by security forces rises to 3, 30 injured

IMPHAL: The death toll in the firing by security forces when a mob tried to storm a CRPF camp in Manipur's Bishnupur district during a protest a day ago rose to three on Wednesday, police said.

The Manipur Police also revised the number of injured in the incident, increasing it to 30.

A large number of youths and women were holding a

protest against the killing of the two children in a bomb attack by suspected militants in the Moirang Tronglaobi area on Tuesday, when the situation turned violent.

In a statement, police said security forces resorted to firing when the around 500-strong mob tried to force their way into the CRPF camp at Gelmol village in Bishnupur district.

in Manipur”, and said the probe would be handed over to the National Investigation Agency (NIA).

“I condemn it in the strongest possible terms. Let there be no doubt, those responsible will be identified, hunted down and dealt with firmly under the law. Such acts of terror will not be tolerated under any circumstances,” he said.

Low-lying Moirang

Tronglaobi is located close to hill areas of Churachandpur and witnessed consistent gun firing during the ethnic conflict between Meiteis and Kuki-Zo groups in 2023 and 2024.

Later in the day, a mob stormed a CRPF camp at Gelmol in the district, burnt vehicles and vandalised portions of the camp, leading to firing by security personnel, which claimed the lives of two persons.

‘Rejection of motion to remove CEC an assault on Parliamentary democracy’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The INDIA Bloc took its battle over electoral integrity to the Constitution Club in New Delhi on Wednesday, denouncing the rejection of their motion to remove Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar as an assault on Parliamentary democracy and warning that the fight was far from over.

Senior Congress leader Abhishek Manu Singhvi, flanked by leaders from seven Opposition parties, said, “What happened is extraordinary.” The motion had been thrown out at the very first gate no inquiry ordered, no charges examined, no floor debate permitted. Singhvi's core grievance was procedural as much as political. He said that when nearly 200 elected

representatives collectively move a removal notice, the presiding officers of Parliament are obliged, at a minimum, to give written reasons for rejecting it. Neither Speaker Om Birla nor Rajya Sabha Chairman CP Radhakrishnan did so. Both issued identical one-line bulletins citing a “careful and objective assessment” and left it there, he added.

The India Bloc is now weighing a legal challenge in the Supreme Court. The question of who holds the Election Commission accountable, they insist, cannot go unanswered.

The motion itself, filed on March 12, carried the signatures of 130 Lok Sabha members and 63 Rajya Sabha members, for a total of 193, making it the first such impeachment attempt against a sitting Chief Election Commissioner. The charges

NCERT revamps curriculum committee after Supreme Court rap over Class 8 textbook

‘Reconstitution of NSTC undertaken to strengthen it through necessary updates’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The NCERT has reconstituted its curriculum committee after being rapped by the Supreme Court over a section on “Corruption in Judiciary” in the now-withdrawn Class 8 Social Science textbook, officials said on Wednesday.

The high-powered, 20-member National Syllabus and Teaching Learning Material Committee (NSTC) of the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) includes IIT Madras Director V Kamakoti; Indian Council of Historical Research Chairman Raghuvendra Tanwar; former Vice-Chancellor of the National Law School of India University R Venkata Rao; and Amarendra Prasad Behera, Joint Director-in-Charge, Central Institute of Educational

Takeaways

- » The high-powered, 20-member NSTC of the NCERT includes IIT Madras Director V Kamakoti; Indian Council of Historical Research Chairman Raghuvendra Tanwar; former VC of the National Law School of India University R Venkata Rao
- » Following Supreme Court orders, three members have been removed from

Technology, NCERT.

Earlier, the panel had 22 members.

Following Supreme Court orders, three members have been removed from the NSTC.



the NSTC

- » In February, the Supreme Court had taken up suo motu cognisance of the Class 8 Social Science textbook, which discussed a section on ‘Corruption in Judiciary’

These are Michel Danino, former guest professor at IIT Gandhinagar; M D Srinivas, chairman of the Centre for Policy Studies, Chennai; and the late Bibek Debroy, former

Raj: 5 children die in 5 days from mysterious illness

JAIPUR: Five children, including two siblings, have died within five days from a mysterious illness in Rajasthan's Salumber district, officials said on Wednesday.

The children, aged between two and four years, reportedly developed symptoms such as fever and vomiting and died within 24 hours, they said.

The cases were reported from Lalpura and Ghata villages in the Lasadiya sub-division, where health department teams have been deployed to collect samples and monitor the situation.

Officials identified the deceased as Deepak (4), his brother Laxman (3), and Seema (4) from Lalpura village, and Rahul (4) and Kajal (2) from Ghata village.

Eight other children are currently undergoing treatment at hospitals in Salumber and Udaipur, officials said.

Additional District Magistrate Dinesh Rai Sapela said screening of residents was carried out in the affected villages, which have over 560 households.

“Medical teams have conducted screening and any person showing symptoms will receive treatment,” he said, urging villagers to immediately visit the nearest health centre if children show any signs of illness.

Chief Medical and Health Officer Mahendra Parmar said samples have been sent to RNT Medical College for testing, and the exact cause of the illness will be known only after reports are received.

As a precautionary measure, teams from the animal husbandry department also sprayed disinfectants in cattle sheds in Ghata village.

Youth clearing prelims of UPSC, HPSC and judicial exams to receive financial assistance: CM Saini

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini announced that youth who clear the preliminary examinations of UPSC, HPSC, and Judicial Services will be provided financial assistance by the state government to support their further coaching expenses.

He stated that under the “Mukhyamantri Yuva Pratibha Protsahan Yojana”, economically weaker candidates will receive financial assistance ranging from ₹25,000 to ₹70,000.

The CM was addressing a felicitation ceremony for newly selected candidates of the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) held here today.

On this occasion, Cooperation minister Arvind Sharma, Chief Principal Secretary to the

Haryana raises minimum wage of unskilled workers to 15,220 per month

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini while addressing a press conference after the Cabinet meeting held in Chandigarh on Wednesday, said the state government has taken a major decision in the interest of the labour class by increasing the minimum wage of unskilled workers to ₹15,220 per month. This decision will directly ben-

efit lakhs of unskilled workers in the state and improve their standard of living.

The Chief Minister said that during the Budget Session of the Legislative Assembly, he had announced that an expert committee had recommended an increase in the minimum wages of unskilled workers. Fulfilling this announcement, the Cabinet has now approved fixing the minimum wage at ₹15,220 per month.

Chief Minister, Rajesh Khullar, Principal Secretary to the Chief Minister, Arun Kumar Gupta, Commissioner and Secretary



figures such as Sant Ravidas and Maharishi Valmiki.

The move comes at a time when the ruling BJP is working to consolidate its support among non-Jatav Dalit communities, including Pasi and Valmiki groups, which have emerged as key electoral segments in UP.

Political observers view the initiative as an attempt to reinforce the party's outreach by highlighting symbolic and infrastructural measures linked to Dalit identity and representation.

Alongside the statue protection drive, the government has announced plans to improve road connectivity to slums, Scheduled Caste settlements and tribal habitations.

UP: Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati gets ‘death threats’

UP: Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati gets ‘death threats’

VARANASI: Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati has allegedly received death threats through text messages and voice mail, his media in-charge said on Wednesday.

The seer's media in-charge, Sanjay Pandey, said several objectionable text messages were sent from a suspicious phone number on the official phone number of Jyotirmath on April 1. After the number was blocked, two threatening voice messages were received via voice mail on April 6, he said.

Pandey added that the messages contained abusive language and threats to kill the seer.

He said the Shankaracharya is currently running the “Gau Mata Rashtara Mata” campaign and is scheduled to undertake a tour across various Assembly constituencies of Uttar Pradesh from May 3 to raise awareness on cow protection and call for the construction of the “Ram Gau Dham”.

Nation Briefs

ALLAHABAD HC GRANTS INTERIM RELIEF TO EX-UP CMO BY STAYING TRIAL PROCEEDINGS

LUCKNOW: The Allahabad High Court granted interim relief to former chief medical officer (CMO) Dr Anil Kumar Shukla by staying ongoing prosecution proceedings in three cases linked to the National Rural Health Mission (NRHM). The cases are pending before a Special Judge (Anti-Corruption) of the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) in Ghaziabad. The court has directed the CBI to file its reply by the first week of May. A bench of Justice Rajeev Singh passed the order on Tuesday on three separate petitions filed by Shukla under Section 528 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS).

UP: 3-YEAR-OLD DIES AFTER ASSAULT BY STEPMOTHER IN BULANDSHAHR: POLICE

BULANDSHAHR: A three-year-old girl died allegedly after being beaten by her stepmother in the Bulandshahr district, police said on Wednesday. The incident took place in Surjawali village under the Pahasu police station area. According to police, information about the child's death was received following which a team rushed to the spot and initiated an inquiry. Preliminary investigation revealed that the child was allegedly assaulted by her stepmother, identified as Poonam, which led to her deteriorating condition. She was taken to a hospital for treatment, where doctors declared her dead. The accused has been taken into police custody. Shikarpur Circle Officer, said that upon receiving information, police immediately reached the scene and conducted an initial probe.



EDITORIAL

FROM THREAT TO TRUCE

In the span of a single day, President Donald Trump shifted from threatening Iran with “annihilation” to embracing what he called a “workable” plan for a 14-day ceasefire. The abrupt change in tone, announced barely 90 minutes before his own deadline for Tehran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, captured both the volatility of the moment and the improvisational character of this presidency. For weeks, the rhetoric had been escalating, the war grinding into its sixth week with mounting costs and frayed nerves across the region. Then, suddenly, the language of obliteration gave way to talk of “Longterm PEACE.” Behind the scenes, intermediaries — led by Pakistan — scrambled to prevent a wider conflagration. Even China, Iran’s largest trading partner and Washington’s chief economic rival, quietly pressed for de-escalation. The result was not a grand bargain, but a pause: fragile, conditional, and heavy with unanswered questions.

Trump framed the ceasefire as the natural outcome of overwhelming military success. He boasted that the United States and Israel had met and exceeded their objectives, implying that Iran had been bombed into submission. Yet that assumption has always rested on shaky ground. Since 1979, the Islamic Republic has demonstrated a stubborn willingness to endure isolation, sanctions, and war rather than capitulate under pressure. It held American hostages for 444 days at enormous diplomatic cost. It prolonged the brutal Iran-Iraq war deep into the 1980s, absorbing staggering casualties. More recently, it stood by its regional proxies even as those alliances invited devastating retaliation. Tehran’s leadership, however battered, has long signaled that survival — not popularity, not prosperity — is its guiding principle. To imagine that a barrage of airstrikes alone would force unconditional surrender was to misunderstand the regime’s history and temperament.

Nowhere was that miscalculation more evident than in the brinkmanship over the Strait of Hormuz. Roughly a fifth of the world’s oil passes through that narrow corridor between Iran and Oman. Defense analysts broadly agree that the U.S. Navy could seize control of the waterway in short order. The harder question is what comes next. Securing the strait would mean neutralizing missile threats along hundreds of kilometers of Iranian coastline, from Kish Island to Bandar Abbas. That kind of operation would not be a surgical strike but a sprawling commitment, potentially requiring tens of thousands of troops and years of vigilance. American history offers sobering reminders of how “limited” missions metastasize. Vietnam was not meant to last a decade. Afghanistan was not meant to stretch to 20 years. Iraq was supposed to be swift and transformative. The prospect of another open-ended deployment, guarding shipping lanes under constant threat, would have tested both public patience and military readiness.

The terms of the two-week pause underline how complicated the endgame remains. Under the emerging arrangement, both Iran and Oman would be allowed to charge fees on ships transiting Hormuz — a notable departure from the long-standing assumption that the strait functions as an international waterway without tolls. Iranian officials reportedly intend to use the revenue for reconstruction. Critics on Capitol Hill have already denounced the framework as a concession that hands Tehran leverage rather than strips it away. Democratic lawmakers condemned the earlier threat to obliterate civilian infrastructure as morally indefensible and potentially unlawful. Even Pope Leo XIV warned that targeting power plants and similar facilities would violate international norms. In that light, the ceasefire looks less like a triumphal coda and more like a recognition of limits: military, political, and legal.

There is also a pattern at work. Trump has often issued maximalist demands only to recalibrate when faced with economic turbulence, diplomatic resistance, or the sheer complexity of follow-through. Two weeks has become his favored interval — a cushion that allows tempers to cool and options to be reconsidered. He has invoked it in trade disputes, in negotiations over Russia’s war in Ukraine, and in earlier deliberations about striking Iran. Sometimes action comes before the deadline; sometimes the deadline simply fades. The rhythm is familiar: dramatic escalation, market jitters or allied alarm, then a pivot framed as strategic genius. Supporters hail it as dealmaking; critics see improvisation edging toward recklessness. This latest episode fits the mold. After vowing devastation, the president stepped back from the brink, crediting military prowess for creating diplomatic space.

Whether the ceasefire matures into something durable will depend less on rhetoric and more on realism. Iran is weakened but not defeated. The United States is powerful but not omnipotent. The Strait of Hormuz remains a chokepoint not only for oil tankers but for global stability. A 14-day truce cannot by itself unwind decades of hostility or erase the incentives for proxy conflict. Yet it does offer a narrow window to replace threats with negotiation. The alternative — a grinding campaign to dominate hostile territory and patrol contested waters indefinitely — would almost certainly entangle Washington in the very kind of “forever war” Trump once promised to avoid. If this pause signals a recognition of that danger, it may prove more consequential than the bluster that preceded it.

NARI SHAKTI



NARENDRA MODI

The 2029 Lok Sabha elections and the Assembly elections to the various states in the coming times must be conducted with women’s reservation in place

Time to Deliver Representation

Women’s reservation is not merely a policy choice; it is a democratic correction whose time has come and cannot be delayed further

In the coming days, India will be immersed in a festive season, with celebrations taking place across the length and breadth of the nation. The people of Assam will mark Rongali Bihu while Odisha will celebrate Maha Bishuba Pana Sankranti. In West Bengal, Poila Boishakh will usher in the Bengali New Year and in Kerala, Vishu will be observed with immense enthusiasm. In Tamil Nadu, Puthandu will be celebrated, while in Punjab and other parts of Northern India, it will be Baisakhi, which will usher in a spirit of hope as well as positivity. I convey my best wishes to all those across India and the world who are marking these festivals. May these auspicious occasions bring happiness and prosperity to everyone’s lives.

Furthermore, on April 11, we will commence the 200th birth anniversary celebrations of Mahatma Phule, and on the 14th, India will pay homage to Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar on Ambedkar Jayanti.

In addition to these special occasions, when the spirit of renewal fills our hearts and minds, our nation stands at the threshold of another historic occasion. It is an opportunity to deepen the foundations of our democracy and to reaffirm our collective commitment to equality and inclusion.

On the 16th of April, Parliament will be convened to discuss and pass an important bill that advances women’s reservation. To describe this merely as a legislative exercise would be an understatement. It is a reflection of the aspirations of crores of women across India. It is an affirmation of a principle that has long guided our civilisational ethos, that society progresses when women progress. Women constitute nearly half



Women have expanded their presence in education, enterprise, administration, sports and science, yet legislative representation has lagged

of India’s population. Their contributions to our nation are vast and invaluable. Today, India is witnessing remarkable achievements by women across every field. From science and technology to entrepreneurship, from sports to the armed forces and from music to the arts, women are at the forefront of India’s progress. Over the years, sustained efforts have been made to create an enabling environment for women’s empowerment. Greater access to education, improved healthcare, enhanced financial inclusion and better access to basic amenities have strengthened the foundations of women’s participation in economic and social life.

Yet, their representation in the world of politics and legislative bodies has not always been commensurate with their role in society. This is particularly unfortunate because when women participate in adminis-

tration and decision-making, they bring with them experiences and insights that enrich public discourse and improve the quality of governance.

The 2029 Lok Sabha elections and the Assembly elections to the various states in the coming times must be conducted with women’s reservation in place. Over the decades, there have been repeated efforts to provide women with their rightful place in democratic institutions by the previous governments. Committees were made, bill drafts were introduced, but they never saw the light of day. But the broad consensus has remained that women’s representation in legislative bodies has to increase. In September 2023, Parliament passed the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam with the same spirit of consensus. I consider it to be among the most special occasions of my life.

This opportunity to ensure women’s reservation also resonates deeply with the spirit of our Constitution. The makers of our Constitution envisioned a society where equality is both enshrined and realised in practice. Strengthening women’s participation in legislative institutions is an important step towards fulfilling that vision. It reflects our commitment to building a society where every citizen has an equal stake in shaping the nation’s destiny.

This is a moment that cannot be deferred any longer. Every delay in advancing women’s representation is, in effect, a delay in strengthening the quality and inclusiveness of our democracy. For decades, the need for greater participation of women in legislative institutions has been acknowledged, discussed and reaffirmed. To postpone action now would mean extending an imbalance

that we already recognise and have the capacity to correct. At a time when India is moving forward with confidence and purpose, it is essential that our institutions reflect the aspirations of all citizens, especially those who form half our population. Timely action will not only honour long-standing commitments but also ensure that the momentum of progress is sustained. This is truly a historic opportunity to make our democracy more representative, responsive and future-ready.

This moment calls for collective action. It is not about any one government, party or individual. It is about the nation as a whole recognising the importance of this step and coming together to realise it. It is what we owe to our Nari Shakti. That is why the passage of a bill for women’s reservation should reflect the broadest possible consensus and be guided by the larger national interest. Such opportunities call upon us to act not for ourselves, but for future generations. They remind us that the true strength of a democracy lies in its ability to evolve and to become more inclusive over time.

As we approach this historic Parliament sitting, I appeal to all Members of Parliament, across party lines, to come together in support of this important step for the women of India. Let us seize this opportunity with a sense of responsibility and purpose. Let us act in a manner that reflects the highest traditions of our democracy.

India has always shown that when it comes to matters of national importance, it can rise above differences and act with unity. This is one such moment. Let us move forward together and strengthen Constitutional values and empower our Nari Shakti for national progress.

NEXUS OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND A FORMER CIVIL SERVANT

This grassroots initiative moves beyond slogans, enabling young girls to reclaim agency, dignity and self-belief in deeply transformative ways

Oasis Samartha Project was the proud recipient of the Nexus of Good Annual Award 2025, conferred by a distinguished jury led by Mr Deepak Gupta, Former Chairman, UPSC. At its heart, Saamartha — meaning inner strength — is a movement from fear to freedom and silence to strength. It stands for the awakening of young Indian girls to their inherent dignity, courage, and right to self-determination. Through education, experiential learning, and community engagement, Saamartha seeks to create a generation of young women who live with clarity, confidence, and compassion. **Philosophy Behind Saamartha**

The philosophy of Saamartha is simple yet transformative: empowerment is not given; it is realised from within.

Our society often teaches girls to adjust, to comply, and to be careful — but rarely to be courageous, questioning, or self-reliant. Saamartha begins by challenging this conditioning. It believes that empowerment is not about rebellion or imitation of men, but about awakening the natural strength that already exists within every girl.

The project is built around twelve core themes, which together form the foundation of conceptual clarity for empowerment:

- Understanding gender inequality and its roots,
- Recognising discrimination even within “educated” homes,
- Breaking taboos around menstruation,
- Confronting violence — both visible and silent,
- Resolving career conflicts and daring to dream,
- Questioning marriage customs that suppress women,
- Understanding patriarchal systems,
- Resisting objectification,
- Building financial and emotional independence,
- Redefining equality through dignity, not imitation,
- Realising that belief shapes destiny, and
- Accepting that freedom must be earned, not handed down.

Each of these themes is not only discussed intellectually but experienced through group reflections, creative expression, and real-life interactions in our three-day residential empowerment camps.

The aim is not mere awareness, but

From Silence to Strength

Saamartha is building a generation of confident young women by challenging social conditioning and nurturing courage, clarity and compassion through experiential learning and dialogue



Saamartha is quietly building a generation of women defined by courage, clarity and conscious leadership REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE

VOICES OF TRANSFORMATION

“Before coming to Oasis, I felt like a victim. I was made to challenge my own mindset. I don’t blame anyone today — I take full responsibility.” — AATMAJA SONI

“I was in a cage of my own thoughts and social beliefs. Today, I’m living life on my own terms, flying in my biggest sky. Feeling grateful!” — VAISHNAVI TAPANIA

“Oasis has taught me the courage to live my dreams responsibly — neither to seek approval nor to live in a carefree way.” — DIVYA HADIA

“I was taught that I’m weak and can’t do anything without support. Today, I’m living independently and supporting my wider family. I feel I am enough.” — DINKAL GAEKWAD

awakening — the courage to act with understanding, not anger.

Concept to Community

The Saamartha Project translates this vision into a living experience through workshops, leadership camps, and community initiatives designed for teenage and young adult girls (13–25 years). Our 3-day empowerment camps are the soul of the project. Conducted in diverse settings — from small villages in Rajasthan and Odisha to urban schools in Delhi and Gujarat — these camps bring girls together to reflect on real-life challenges. Through storytelling, theatre, self-expression, and deep dialogue, participants learn to identify internalised fear, discover their strengths, and articulate their dreams. Parallely, the project

engages parents and teachers, sensitising them to the subtle ways in which social conditioning limits girls. Empowerment cannot happen in isolation; it must happen within ecosystems of understanding.

Over time, Saamartha has evolved from a series of camps into a growing social movement. Today, it operates across several Indian states — Gujarat, Delhi, Jammu & Kashmir, Rajasthan, Odisha, Karnataka, and Kerala — and the stories of girls who found their voice have begun to inspire people internationally. The ripple effect is visible in the girls who return from our programs — more assertive, more aware, and more compassionate. Some have started local initiatives in their own schools and villages, taking the message forward in

their communities.

Empowerment with Responsibility

The Saamartha philosophy does not promote confrontation. It promotes courage with conscience. It reminds girls that empowerment is not rebellion but responsibility — the responsibility to live with integrity, to stand for truth, and to lead with compassion.

It is taught that misuse of power — even by women — is anti-empowerment. True strength does not lie in dominating men but in creating a society where both genders coexist with respect and fairness. Empowerment must always remain rooted in ethics and equality.

The Larger Dream

The work aligns with the broader national goal of building an India where every girl — regardless of her background — has the right to education, freedom, and opportunity.

Through the “Educate, Empower, Enable” model:

- Girls are educated conceptually — giving them clarity about freedom, equality, and self-worth.
- They are empowered emotionally — helping them find courage and voice.
- They are enabled practically — connecting them with mentors, vocational guidance, and life skills.

In the process, Saamartha bridges the gap between thought and transformation.

Why Saamartha Matters Today

In a world that still conditions girls to seek validation, Saamartha reminds them to seek value. In a society that measures women by sacrifice, Saamartha measures them by self-realisation. And in a culture that often worships womanhood symbolically but limits it socially, Saamartha dares to bridge that contradiction. This award comes as a reminder that our journey is not just ours — it is part of a collective awakening that India is witnessing.

Every girl who stands up with courage brings light to her community.

Every educator who joins the movement strengthens the foundation of equality. Saamartha presents a wonderful example of Nexus of Good. The model put in place is replicable and scalable through a public-private partnership. Saamartha is not just a project. It is a movement — a movement from fear to freedom, from silence to strength, and from hope to courage to true independence.

Views expressed are personal

JURISDICTION ROW

Adani wins US court hearing in push to throw out SEC fraud suit

NEW YORK: A US judge granted a request from billion-
aire Gautam Adani to schedule
a hearing in his effort to dismiss
a US Securities and Exchange
Commission fraud case, which
he says lacks necessary jurisdic-
tion as well as fails on multiple
reasons.

This followed lawyers of
Adani and his nephew, Sagar
filing a plea seeking dismissal
of the case.

“The court has received
Defendants’ letter requesting
a pre-motion conference on
their anticipated motion to
dismiss the Complaint. The
court GRANTS that request
and DIRECTS the parties” to
schedule the pre-motion con-
ference, the Eastern District



court of New York said in its
order.

In the filing, the Adanis’
lawyers said there was no cred-
ible evidence supporting the
alleged bribery scheme.

The SEC, they said, lacked
necessary jurisdiction over the
two men and that the alleged
misstatements underpinning
the case weren’t actionable.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » This followed lawyers of Adani and his nephew, Sagar filing a plea seeking dismissal of the case
- » In the filing, the Adanis’ lawyers said there was no credible evidence supporting alleged bribery scheme

the Adani Group, Sagar Adani
is executive director at Adani
Green Energy.

The lawsuits had been
stalled for over a year as the
defendants, based in India,
were not served notices.
The group, which spans
green energy, ports, realty,
mining and news media, has
continued to raise funds from
global investors, including
BlackRock, since the charges
were filed.

The Brooklyn, New York
court’s decision to grant a
hearing allows Adani to argue
that the regulator’s complaint
should be thrown out at an
early stage, potentially avoid-
ing a protracted discovery pro-
cess and trial.

AGENCIES

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: A sudden shift
in aviation fees emerges amid
growing pressure from higher
fuel prices linked to unrest in
West Asia. To ease financial
strain on carriers, authorities
have adjusted ground service
tariffs for local flight opera-
tors, the officials informed on
Wednesday.

A quarter drop in landing
and storage expenses will apply
across Indian airports begin-
ning immediately. This tempo-
rary change lasts exactly ninety
days without possibility of
extension. Decisions followed
internal reviews assessing eco-
nomic stress within the airline
sector. Charges normally con-
tribute significantly to airport
revenue streams. The adjust-
ment reflects sensitivity to
operational cost spikes beyond
carrier control.

INSIGHT

- » Financial relief targets only services operating inside national borders
- » The step aligns with wider efforts to assist air travel amid growing difficulties tied to soaring worldwide aviation turbine fuel rates

Movement comes directly
from the national civil aviation
office. Financial relief targets
only services operating inside
national borders. Effects may
influence scheduling and pric-
ing decisions by airlines during
the coming weeks.

This step aligns with wider
efforts to assist air travel amid
growing difficulties tied to soar-
ing worldwide aviation tur-

bine fuel rates. Though global
fuel expenses climbed rapidly,
authorities previously lim-
ited how much of those rising
ATF costs could be transferred
to local airlines – setting a 25
per cent ceiling – to ease finan-
cial pressure on carriers while
avoiding heavier impacts on
travellers.

Despite worldwide chal-
lenges, attention stays fixed on
keeping air travel costs steady,
stated Civil Aviation Minister
Ram Mohan Naidu. With recent
cuts to airport fees, stress on
carriers should ease – thus lim-
iting steep ticket price increases,
he observed. Without delay, a
reduction of 25 per cent in
landing and parking fees now
applies at key airports regulated
by the Airports Economic Regu-
latory Authority of India.

This move follows guidance
from the ministry, taking force
right away.

ALL-TIME HIGH

Securitisation jumps 9% to Rs 2.55L crore in FY26

MUMBAI: Securitisation deals
grew 9 per cent to an all-time
high of Rs 2.55 lakh crore in
2025-26, a report said on
Wednesday.

The January-March quarter
alone witnessed a 20 per cent
year-on-year jump in activity
to take the overall transactions
to Rs 65,000 crore, the report
by Crisil Ratings said.

The surge was led by sig-
nificant growth in originations
by NBFCs, which clocked a 30
per cent year-on-year increase
in value, it said, adding that
banks’ originations were muted

and accounted for only 3 per
cent of the total value in FY26
against 26 per cent in the pre-
vious fiscal.

The overall securitisa-
tion market remains concen-
trated, with the top originators
accounting for the major-
ity share, although there has
been some broad-based
activity of late. The total num-
ber of originators increased to
over 190 in fiscal 2026 from 175
in fiscal 2025, and the share of
the top 20 originators dipped
to 65 per cent from 71 per cent,
it said.

MPOST

M.P. PASCHIM KSHETRA VIDYUT VITRAN CO. LTD.
Office of The Superintending Engineer (O&M) Circle
132 Kasrawad Road GRID, Khargone O&M
Email ID : se_mpskbhargone@rediffmail.com, Telephone No. : 07282-234153
No. SE/O&M/Pur/26-27/NIT-1S-002/ Khargone, Dtd. 08.04.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS

Online-tender is invited for services as per tender specification given below :-

T. S.	Particulars	Tender Value (Approx.) (In lacs)	Last Date of Online Submission of Bid (In lacs)	Due Date of Online Bid Opening
002	Parallel Tender for Empanelment of Contractors to Award a Rate Contract Award (RCA) for Replacement of Broken Damaged Poles/New Construction Works Under O&M Circle Khargone	42.00	21.04.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs	22.04.2026 at 15:00 Hrs

For further information visit our Website <https://www.mpwz.co.in> or <https://www.mptenders.gov.in>

M.P. Madhyam/125261/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

Name of Work with its location	Outsourcing of PSI maintenance activity of 25 KV AC Traction system over DL-LUMB area (PSINUR, PSIPNP, PSIIKDE) for a period of Two years.
Approx. Cost of work	Rs.2,47,07,331.41/-
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs.4,94,200/-
E-Tender Bid Online Submission period	16.04.2026 (00.00 Hrs), to 30.04.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	30.04.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
Fund Allocation	07041032
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
E-Tender No.:	02-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 08.04.2026
	1163/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Akhtar, S/o Usman Sheikh, R/o H.No. B-145, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 283/21, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Akhtar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Akhtar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Akhtar** accused of **FIR No. 283/21, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.05.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, North District
DP/4566/ON/2026 Room No. 114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

1. Name of Work	Standardisation of turnouts & maintenance of track infrastructure in DLI-DKZ and ANDI yard in the section of SSE/Pway/DLI under ADEN/DLI.
2. Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 1,48,70,616.63/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Eight Lakh Seventy Thousand Six Hundred Sixteen and Sixty Three Paise Only)
3. Earnest Money to be Deposited	Rs. 2,97,400.00/- (Rupees Two Lakh Ninety Seven Thousand Four Hundred Only)
4. Cost of tender document	Rs. 0.00/-
5. Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender.	30.04.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen,	www.ireps.gov.in

• The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. • For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. • Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. No. 128-W/280/e -Tender Notice/ NIT/03/2026-27/W-3 Dated: 08.04.2026

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यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
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Toll Free No. 18001808296 वेबसाइट: www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

पत्रांक: वाई.ई.ए./भूलेख/तह0/377/2026 सार्वजनिक सूचना दिनांक: 06.04.2026

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा ग्राम भुनातगा सैक्टर- 34, 33, 11 व ग्राम उटरवाली सैक्टर 13 व आकलपुर सैक्टर 10 के अन्तर्गत आने वाली भूमि का सुनियोजित विकास हेतु सम्बन्धित कृषकों द्वारा दी गयी सहमति की दर रु0 3808 /- प्रतिवर्गमीटर से यमुना विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा शासनादेश संख्या 314 / 77-3-163एफ, दिनांक 23.02.2016 में तय प्रक्रियानुसार निम्नानुसार क्रय किया जाना प्रस्तावित है:-

क्र० सं०	काश्तकार का नाम	खाता संख्या	खसरा संख्या	खसरे का क्षेत्रफल (ह० में)	काश्तकार का भाग	हिस्सानुसार क्षेत्रफल (ह० में)	अन्य विवरण
ग्राम भुनातगा सैक्टर-34							
1.	रामचन्द्र पुत्र मोहर सिंह नि० ग्राम	42	105	0.3350	में से	0.0419	
2.	ज्ञानेन्द्र शर्मा पुत्र सुरेश चन्द शर्मा नि० ग्राम पचोकरा।	36	370	1.6730	में से	0.0950	
3.	हेमराज पुत्र सोहन नि० ग्राम	17	338	1.0380	में से	0.0666	
4.	वीरवली देवी पत्नी सरवन सिंह नि० ग्राम	17	338	1.0380	में से	0.0581	
5.	धर्मात्पल उर्फ धरमपाल पुत्र हुलसी नि० ग्राम	84	354	0.1290	में से	0.0430	
ग्राम भुनातगा सैक्टर-33 व 11							
6.	रुचि गुप्ता पत्नी पंकज गुप्ता निवासी मो नो 320, एफ-30, नोएडा।	213	470	3.2720	में से	0.0630	
7.	चिंकू शर्मा, मनोष कुमार शर्मा, रिकू शर्मा पुत्रगण अशोक शर्मा व रीता शर्मा पत्नी अशोक शर्मा निवासी मोहल्ला शान्ति नगर, रबूपुरा।	196	182	0.9490	में से	0.0632	
ग्राम उटरवाली सैक्टर-13							
8.	श्रीमती शकुन्तला देवी पत्नी महेन्द्र प्रकाश निवासी हीरा कॉलोनी, सिकन्द्राबाद, बुलन्दशहर।	480	876	0.8040	सम्पूर्ण	0.8040	
9.	हंसराज सिंह पुत्र विजय सिंह निवासी गरिमा गार्डन, साहिबाद, गाजियाबाद।	408	55	0.6860	में से	0.0843	
ग्राम आकलपुर सैक्टर-10							
10.	यशवन्ती पत्नी महेश चन्द शर्मा नि० ग्राम	147	307	2.3520	में से	0.1176	
11.	कुलदीप सिंह, कृष्ण पुत्रगण प्रताप सिंह नि० ग्राम	126	309/2	1.1050	में से	0.0395	
12.	प्रदीप सिंह माटी पुत्र जय सिंह माटी नि० ग्राम	152	293	4.2360	में से	0.1265	
13.	प्रेमपाल सिंह पुत्र तुलाराम नि० ग्राम	152	293	4.2360	में से	0.0235	

अतः उपरोक्त भूमि क्रय किये जाने में यदि किसी व्यक्ति को कोई आपत्ति है, तो वह लिखित रूप में 15 दिवस के अंदर यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण कार्यालय / सीओआरसैल में अपनी आपत्ति प्रस्तुत कर सकता है।

विशेष कार्याधिकारी /उप जिलाधिकारी
यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिसूचित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लान के अतिरिक्त प्लॉटिंग/हाउसिंग/कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध है। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीदफरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनाइजर के भ्रामक विज्ञापनों से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

झारखण्ड सरकार

कृषि, पशुपालन एवं सहकारिता विभाग

(सहकारिता प्रभाग)

झारखण्ड राज्य लघुवनोंपज सहकारी विकास एवं विपणन संघ लि.

(झाम्फकोफेड लि०, राँची)एचतुर्थ तल, पशुपालन भवन, हेसाग, राँची-834003, झारखण्ड

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झाम्फकोफेड से सम्बन्ध सहकारी समितियों /लैम्प्स/पैक्स/वन घन विकास केन्द्र /स्वयं सहायता समूह/ FPO आदि के चयन हेतु अल्पकालीन इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति का आमंत्रण

फेडरेशन के आधारभूत संरचना विकास हेतु अनुदान योजना अन्तर्गत कृषि, पशुपालन एवं सहकारिता विभाग (सहकारिता प्रभाग), झारखण्ड सरकार द्वारा झारखण्ड राज्य लघुवनोंपज सहकारी विकास एवं विपणन संघ लि. (झाम्फकोफेड), को प्राप निम्न योजनाओं के क्रियान्वयन हेतु सम्बन्ध सहकारियों से इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति आमंत्रित की जाती है। Solar Agro- MFP Processing unit, Sustainable Harvesting of MFP By Modern Tools and Technique, झाम्फकोफेड से सम्बन्ध सहकारी समितियों/ लैम्प्स/पैक्स/वन घन विकास केन्द्र /स्वयं सहायता समूह / किसान उत्पादक संगठन (FPO) आदि को योजना अन्तर्गत अनुदान पर प्रसंस्करण इकाई/ Sustainable Harvesting Tool Kit उपलब्ध कराई जाणी। सम्बन्ध सहकारियों से निर्धारित निम्न एवं शर्तों के अधीन विहित प्रपत्र में दिनांक 20.04.2026 (सोमवार) के अपो- 0500 बजे तक इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति का आवेदन आमंत्रित की जाती है। आवेदन झाम्फकोफेड कार्यालय में निर्धारित तिथि तक हाथों-हाथ अथवा डाक के माध्यम से जमा किया जा सकता है। विहित प्रपत्र, निम्न एवं शर्तें झाम्फकोफेड कार्यालय के सूचना पट्ट एवं झाम्फकोफेड के वेबसाइट:- www.jhamfcofed.in पर भी उपलब्ध है। अधिक जानकारी के लिए झाम्फकोफेड कार्यालय 0651-3510563 अथवा श्री चन्द्रशेखर तिवारी (विपणन प्रमुख), मोबाईल नं०- 8825331461 से सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

ह०/-
प्रबंध निदेशक
झाम्फकोफेड लि०, राँची

PR 376937 Co-opretive(26-27).D

OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-I, DELHI
4th FLOOR, JEEVAN TARA BUILDING, PARLIAMENT STREET, NEW DELHI-110001

SALE PROCLAMATION

T.R.C. No.1805/2022 Date of Auction Sale: 15/05/2026

PROCLAMATION OF SALE UNDER RULE 38, 52(2) OF SECOND SCHEDULE TO THE INCOME TAX ACT, 1961 READ WITH THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS DUE TO BANK AND FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS ACT, 1993.

CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA

Vs.

M/S. RIDAUS AUTO COMPONENTS PVT. LTD. AND ORS.

- (CD 1) M/S RIDAUS AUTO COMPONENTS PVT. LTD., At 2nd Mile Stone, Vikas Nagar, Basai Road, Gurugram, Haryana.
- (CD 2) PRADEEP SHARMA S/O THAKUR DASS, DIRECTOR / GUARANTOR OF M/S RIDAUS AUTO COMPONENTS PVT. LTD., R/o C-8, 8801, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi.
- Also At: House NO.801, Block 1, Palam Vihar, Gurugram, Haryana.
- (CD 3) RUCHIRAA SHARMA D/O MEGHRAJ SHARMA, DIRECTOR / GUARANTOR OF M/S. RIDAUS AUTO COMPONENTS PVT. LTD., R/o C-8, 8801, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi.
- Also At: House NO.801, Block 1, Palam Vihar, Gurugram, Haryana.
- (CD 4) SARLA SHARMA W/O THAKUR DASS, (SINCE DECEASED) THROUGH HER LRS,
- (i) Manoj Sharma (Son)
- (ii) Pradeep Sharma (Son) (Already on Record as CD No.2)
- (iii) Ms. Vijay Sharma (Daughter)
- (iv) Ms. Preeti Sharma (Daughter)
- All Are R/o C-8, 8801, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi
- Also At: 1-881, First Floor, Palam Vihar, Gurugram, Haryana-122017.

- Whereas Transfer Recovery Certificate No.1805/2022 in TA No.338 of 2017 drawn by the Presiding Officer, Debts Recovery Tribunal-I for the recovery of a sum of Rs.4,14,72,455.00 together with costs and future interest @ 13.70% p.a., from the date of filing of O.A. i.e. 21/04/2017, till its realization and also to pay cost as per recovery certificate from the Certificate debtors together with costs and charges as per recovery certificate.
- And whereas the undersigned has ordered the sale of property mentioned in the Schedule below in satisfaction of the said Certificate.
- And whereas there will be due there under a sum of Rs.4,14,72,455.00, together with costs and future interest @ 13.70% p.a., from the date of filing of OA i.e. 21/04/2017, till its realization and also to pay cost as per recovery certificate. Notice is hereby given that in absence of any order of postponement, the property / properties as under shall be sold by e-auction and bidding shall take place through "On line Electronic Bidding" through the website <https://www.bankauction.in> on 15/05/2026 between 12:00 PM and 01:00 PM with extensions of 5 minutes duration after 01:00 PM, if required.
- The description of the property proposed to be e-auctioned is as follows :

S.No.	Description of Property	Reserve Price (In Rs.)	EMD
1.	Property i.e. Land and Building Situated at New Plot No.143, Khasra No. 6/17, 2nd Mile Stone Vikas Nagar, Bassai Road, Gurgaon, Haryana. Measuring 250 Sq.Yds.	Rs.1.63 Crores	Rs.16.30 Lakhs
5.	The EMD shall be paid through Demand Draft / Pay Order in favour of Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi- A/c. T.R.C. No.1805/2022 along with self - attested copy of Identity (voter I-card/Driving License/Passport) which should contain the address for future communication and self-attested copy of PAN Card must reach to the Office of the Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi latest by 12/05/2026 before 5:00 PM. The EMD received thereafter shall not be considered. The said deposit be adjusted in the case of successful bidders. The unsuccessful bidder shall take return of the EMD directly from the Registry, DRT-I, Delhi after receipt of such report from e-auction service provider / bank / financial institution on closure of the e-auction sale proceedings.		
6.	The envelope containing EMD should be super-scribed "T.R.C. No.1805/2022" alongwith the details of the sender i.e. address, e-mail ID and Mobile Number etc.		
7.	Intending bidders shall hold a valid Login ID and Password to participate in the E-Auction email address and PAN Number. For details with regard to Login ID & Password, please contact M/s 4 Closure, 605A, 6th Floor, Maitrivanam, Amerpet, Hyderabad - 500038, 8142000030, 8142000060 E-mail: info@bankauctions.in , shallendra@bankauctions.in .		
8.	Prospective bidders are required to register themselves with the portal and obtain user ID/Password well in advance, which is mandatory for bidding in above e-auction from M/s 4 Closure.		
9.	Details of concerned Bank Officers / Helpline Numbers etc. are as under :-		

- | Name & Designation | Email & Phone Nos. |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| NAVEEN KUMAR SINGH, (Senior Manager) | Mob: 9999210655
E-mail: bmde12586@centralbank.bank.in |
- What is proposed to be sold are the rights to which the certificate debtors are entitled in respect of the properties. The properties will be sold along with liabilities, if any. The extent of the properties shown in the proclamation is as per the Recovery Certificate schedule. Recovery Officer shall not be responsible for any variation in the extent due to any reason. The properties will be sold on "As is where is" and "as is what is" condition.
 - The property can be inspected by prospective bidder(s) before the date of sale for which the above named officer of the bank may be contacted.
 - The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids if found unreasonable or postpone the auction at any time without assigning any reason.
 - EMD of unsuccessful bidders will be received by such bidders from the Registry of DRT-I, on identification / production of Identity proof viz., PAN Card, Passport, Voters ID, Valid Driving License or Photo Identity Card issued by Govt. and PSUs. Unsuccessful bidders shall ensure return of their EMD and, if not received within a reasonable time, immediately contact the Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi / or the Bank.
 - The sale will be of the property of the above named CDs as mentioned in the schedule below and the liabilities and claims attaching to the said property, so far as they have been ascertained are those specified in the schedule against each lot.
 - The property will be put up for the sale in the lots specified in the schedule. If the amount to be realized is satisfied by the sale of a portion of the property, the sale shall be immediately stopped with respect to the remainder. The sale also be stopped if, before any lot is knocked down, the arrears mentioned in the said certificate, interest costs (including cost of the sale) are tendered to the officer conducting the sale or proof is given to his satisfaction that the amount of such certificate, interest and costs have been paid to the undersigned.
 - No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with sale, however, either directly or indirectly bid for, acquire or attempt to acquire any interest in the property sold.
 - The sale shall be subject to the conditions prescribed in the Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 and the rules made there under and to the further following conditions : The particulars specified in the annexed schedule have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, mis-statement or omission in this proclamation.
 - The amount by which the biddings are to be increased shall be in multiple of Rs.1,00,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Only). In the event of any dispute arising as to the amount of bid, or as to the bidder, the lot shall at once be again put up to auction.
 - The Successful / Highest bidder shall be declared to be the purchaser of any lot provided that further that the amount bid by him is not less than the reserve price. It shall be in the discretion of the undersigned to decline acceptance of the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so.
 - Successful / Highest bidder shall have to prepare DD / Pay Order for 25% of the sale proceeds favouring Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi, A/c. T.R.C. No.1805 / 2022 within 24 hours after close of e-auction and after adjusting the earnest money (EMD) and sending / depositing the same in the office of the Recovery Officer so as to reach within 3 days from the close of e-auction failing which the earnest money (EMD) shall be forfeited.
 - The successful / Highest Bidder shall deposit, through Demand Draft / Pay Order favouring Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Delhi A/c. T.R.C.1805 / 2022, the balance 75% of the sale proceeds before the Recovery Officer, DRT-I on or before 15th Day from the date of sale of the property, exclusive of such day, or if the 15th day be Sunday or other holiday, then on the first office day after the 15th day alongwith the poundage fee @ 2% upto Rs.1,000 and @ 1% on the excess of such gross amount over Rs.1000/- in favour of Registrar, DRT-I, Delhi. (In case of deposit of balance amount of 75% through post the same should reach the Recovery Officer as above).
 - In case of default of payment within the prescribed period, the property shall be resold, after the issue of fresh proclamation of sale. The deposit, after defraying the expenses of the sale, may, if the undersigned thinks fit, be forfeited to the Government and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may subsequently be sold.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY				
Lot No.	Description of the property to be sold with the names of the co-owners where the property belongs to the defaulter and any other person as co-owners	Revenue assessed upon the property or any part thereof	Details of any encumbrance to which property is liable	Claims, if any, which have been put forward to the property, and any other known particulars bearing on its nature and value
1.	Property i.e. Land and Building Situated at New Plot No.143, Khasra No. 6/17, 2nd Mile Stone Vikas Nagar, Bassai Road, Gurgaon, Haryana. Measuring 250 Sq.Yds.			No information received.
SEAL OF COURT		Given under my hand and seal on 20/03/2026	Sd/- NIRANJAN SHARMA, RECOVERY OFFICER-II, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-I, DELHI	

INDIA'S ECONOMIC GROWTH OUTLOOK

RBI expects 6.9% GDP growth in FY27

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank on Wednesday projected India's GDP growth for the current financial year at 6.9 per cent, lower than 7.6 per cent estimated for 2025-26, amid elevated commodity prices and supply chain disruptions originating from West Asia crisis.

Unveiling the first bi-monthly monetary policy for 2026-27, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said the merchandise exports may be adversely impacted by disruptions in key shipping routes and the concomitant rise in freight and insurance costs. On the other hand, sustained momentum in the services sector, the persisting impact of GST rationalisation, rising capacity utilisation in manufacturing, and healthy balance sheets of financial institutions and corporates should continue to support domestic demand, he said.

"India's macroeconomic fundamentals exuded confidence with buoyant growth and low inflation. Conditions turned adverse in March with the widening of the conflict zone and its



Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra at a press conference at the RBI headquarters in Mumbai on Wednesday

intensification," Malhotra said.

He emphasised that the fundamentals of the Indian economy are on a stronger footing at the current juncture than in previous crisis episodes, as well as relative to many other economies, providing it with greater resilience to withstand shocks. The Governor said higher input costs associated with an increase in energy prices and international freight and insurance costs, along with supply-chain disruptions that

would constrain availability of key inputs for downstream sectors, would impair growth.

Also, the government has taken several measures targeted at supporting exports and protecting supply chains. This should mitigate the adverse impact of the conflict.

"The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) opined that the intensity and the duration of the conflict and the resultant damage to the energy and other infrastruc-

KEY POINTS

» The RBI Guv said the merchandise exports may be adversely impacted by disruptions in shipping routes and the concomitant rise in freight & insurance costs

» 'The fundamentals of the Indian economy are on a stronger footing...'

ture add risk to the inflation and growth outlooks," he said. Taking all these factors into consideration, the RBI said real GDP growth for 2026-27 is projected at 6.9 per cent, with Q1 at 6.8 per cent; Q2 at 6.7 per cent; Q3 at 7 per cent; and Q4 at 7.2 per cent. He also said merchandise exports may benefit from the recent trade agreements, while services exports are expected to remain resilient. 'Excessive speculation led to rupee movements'

The Reserve Bank said "excessive speculation" on the rupee prompted surprise actions on the currency front in the last fort-

night, but clarified that its measures will not remain forever. "In the last few weeks of March, we have witnessed heightened volatility in the foreign exchange market. These measures are reactions to the specific market movements. They are not signalling any structural changes. These are not measures going to remain forever," Malhotra said in a post-policy press conference.

Deputy Governor T Rabi Sankar said there was an "artificial drying up" of supply in the market during those days, which led to the measures.

The comments from the apex bank came for the first time after it capped NOP-rupee positions in the onshore deliverable market at USD 100 million and barred authorised dealers from offering non-deliverable forwards. The first measure helped the local currency to appreciate sharply, but gains were reversed within a few hours of trading. The second measure, stopping authorised dealers from offering NDF, helped the rupee significantly, and it appreciated over 2 per cent in a single day.

US-IRAN CEASEFIRE BOOST

Sensex, Nifty jump nearly 4%

MPOST BUREAU

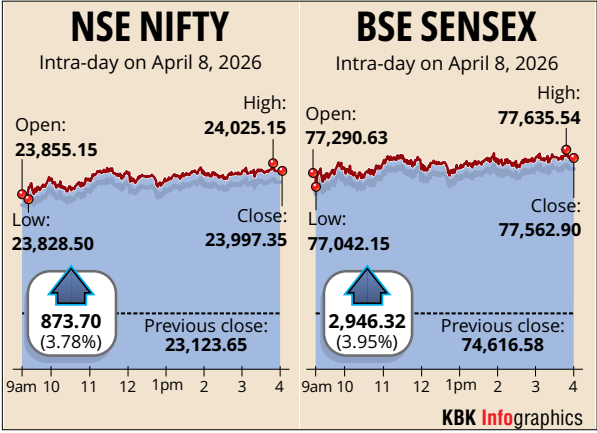
MUMBAI: Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended nearly 4 per cent higher on Wednesday, following an impressive rally in global markets and a drop in crude oil prices, after the US and Iran announced a ceasefire.

Rallying for the fifth day in a row, the 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 2,946.32 points or 3.95 per cent to settle at 77,562.90. During the day, it surged 3,018.96 points or 4 per cent to 77,635.54.

The 50-share NSE Nifty soared 873.70 points or 3.78 per cent to end at 23,997.35. It rallied 901.5 points or 3.89 per cent to 24,025.15 during intra-day trade.

From the Sensex pack, InterGlobe Aviation jumped the most by 8.22 per cent. Larsen & Toubro, Bajaj Finance, Mahindra & Mahindra, Axis Bank and Maruti were also among the prominent gainers.

Tech Mahindra, Sun Pharma and Power Grid were the laggards.



Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, tumbled 13.89 per cent to USD 94.09 per barrel. Energy markets reacted sharply to the ceasefire developments, he said.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 8,692.11 crore on Tuesday, according to exchange data. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs), however, bought stocks worth Rs 7,979.50 crore.

Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments

Limited, said, "The interim ceasefire is seen as a step toward broader regional stability. India benefits immediately from the reopening of the Hormuz Strait, which has pushed oil prices below USD 100 and reduced downside risks to FY27 EPS growth."

The sharp improvement in sentiment has driven a notable decline in the 10-year bond yield and strengthened the rupee, while the RBI's status quo stance has further supported financials, he added.

RBI to come out with new NBFC framework

'Lack of clarity' on Tata Sons' listing

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Reserve Bank Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Wednesday announced that the monetary authority will be coming out with a new framework for non-bank lenders amid a lack of clarity over Tata Sons' listing issue.

"We are coming up with a new framework for the NBFCs. Very soon, we should," Malhotra told reporters at the customary post-policy review press conference.

On a specific question on Tata Sons, Malhotra said the new framework will categorise non-banking finance companies.

He, however, did not elaborate further on the matter, which has been tracked intensely because the RBI is likely to decide if Tata Sons, the holding company of the salts-to-software conglomerate, continues to be privately held or is forced to list.

As per the existing rules from the RBI, Tata Sons, a core investment company, should have been listed by September 30 last year because it is included in a set of 15 entities in the upper layer bracket. Barring Tata Sons, all other entities have complied with the provision.

Previously, Malhotra had said that an entity can continue doing business till its license is cancelled and declined any further comment, even though the timeline for mandatory listing has passed.

Getting listed will thrust

HIGHLIGHTS

» On a specific question on Tata Sons, Malhotra said the new framework will categorise NBFCs

» He, however, did not elaborate further on the matter, which has been tracked intensely because the RBI is likely to decide if Tata Sons continues to be privately held or is forced to list

» As per the existing rules of the RBI, Tata Sons, a core investment company, should have been listed by September 30 last year

a slew of compliance burdens focused towards more disclosures on Tata Sons, while some argue that complying with the asks may be difficult for the diversified corporate grouping, which is present across a slew of businesses at various levels of maturity.

A listing will come as a huge positive for the Shapoorji Pallonji Group, the single largest private owner in the conglomerate, with over 18 per cent, which is going through financial turbulence.

Meanwhile, Malhotra declined to comment when asked about the arrest of Fino Payments Bank's chief executive Rishi Gupta, and if it will hamper its ambitions to convert into a small finance bank, for which the RBI has given an in-principle nod previously.

NTPC, EDF ink pact for cooperation in nuclear power

NEW DELHI: NTPC Limited has signed a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Electricité de France (EDF) to explore cooperation in developing nuclear power projects in India, following government approvals.

The MoU, signed by Arnada Prasad Samal of NTPC and Vakisasi Ramany of EDF, sets a framework to jointly assess the feasibility of deploying EDF's EPR technology in India. The collaboration will examine localisation opportunities, tariff structures, potential project sites and technical support.

It also includes plans for capacity building through training programmes.

The initiative aligns with NTPC's strategy to expand into clean and reliable energy. MPOST

No governance issues found, says RBI Guv Malhotra on HDFC Bank

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank did not come across any governance or conduct-related issues during supervisory inspection of HDFC Bank, Governor Sanjay Malhotra said on Wednesday.

Responding to a question at the post-monetary policy press conference on sudden resignation of HDFC Bank Chairman Atanu Chakraborty and subsequent fall in its share price, Malhotra said Reserve Bank had also seen minutes of meetings of the lender, and the RBI did not find any thing of material concern.

He said the RBI in its press release on March 19 too had said there were no material concerns on record as regards the bank's conduct or governance.

"HDFC Bank is a Domestic Systemically Important Bank

INSIGHT

» RBI Governor Malhotra said Reserve Bank had also seen minutes of meetings of the lender, and the RBI did not find any thing of material concern

» He said the RBI in its press release on March



19 too had said there were no material concerns on record as regards the bank's conduct or governance

(D-SIB) with sound financials, professionally run board and competent management team. Basis our periodical assessment, there are no material concerns on record as regards its conduct or governance," the Reserve Bank said in its press release.

Chakraborty had resigned on March 18.

Malhotra also asserted that India's banking system is "very

resilient, safe, and strong".

He said there is no systemic risks with regard to profitability and health of banks amid the West Asia conflict.

To another question, the Governor indicated that the low interest rates regime may continue for long.

He also said measures recently taken by the RBI to check volatility of rupee will not remain forever.

ISA delegation meets Odisha CM, discusses steel sector opportunities

MPOST BUREAU

BHUBANESWAR: A high-level delegation of the Indian Steel Association, led by MP and its president Naveen Jindal, met Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi to discuss key challenges and opportunities in the state's steel sector.

Senior officials, including Chief Secretary Anu Garg and top representatives from industries and mining departments, attended the meeting. The delegation highlighted Odisha's pivotal role as a leading steel-producing state and appreci-



ated the government's support to the sector.

The ISA proposed measures to boost iron ore availability for state-based industries and sought fiscal incentives to attract investments needed to achieve Odisha's target of 100 MTPA steel production

capacity by 2030. It also recommended setting up a dedicated task force to develop a comprehensive logistics and infrastructure roadmap.

Addressing the media, Jindal praised the state's mining policy and auction process, calling it among the best in the country.

He stressed the need to scale up iron ore production and urged priority allocation for local steel industries by the Odisha Mining Corporation.

The CM assured that adequate iron ore supply would be ensured for industries.

NFL installs RO water coolers at 32 MCD schools



NEW DELHI: National Fertilizers Limited has installed 56 water coolers with RO purifiers across 32 MCD schools in Delhi's Shahdara North Zone under its CSR initiative, benefiting over 25,000 girl students.

The project aims to ensure access to safe and clean drinking water, especially during the summer months. Inauguration ceremonies were held on April 6 at select schools in Brahmapuri, Bhajanpura, Ghonda and Yamuna Vihar.

The events were attended by Amit Kumar Sharma, IRS, CVO (NFL), along with municipal councillors and company officials. Students and school staff participated enthusiastically, highlighting the positive grassroots impact of the initiative. MPOST

'India's private debt mkt surges: Venture debt, growth credit at USD 3-bn in 2025'

Fintech accounted for largest share of capital deployment at over \$600 mn

NEW DELHI: The country's private debt market is gaining momentum, with venture debt deployments touching USD 1.3 billion and growth credit at USD 1.68 billion in 2025, signalling a structural shift in startup financing, according to a report released by Stride Ventures on Wednesday.

Private debt is increasingly moving beyond its traditional role of runway extension to support expansion, acquisitions and capital structuring, it added. According to Stride Ventures' Global Private Debt Report 2026, venture debt deployments reached about USD 1.3 billion across nearly 187 startups in 2025, reflecting growing institutional acceptance of non-dilutive capital.

Activity remained concentrated in major startup hubs, with Delhi-NCR leading at USD 617 million across 64 deals, followed by Bengaluru at USD 333 million across 58 deals and Mumbai at USD 115 million across 30 deals. Sector-wise, fintech accounted for the largest share of capital deployment at over USD 600 million, while consumer-focused startups led in deal volume (60).



ment at over USD 600 million, while consumer-focused startups led in deal volume (60).

Alongside this, growth credit is emerging as a complementary layer in the capital stack, particularly for late-stage companies. Indian firms raised about USD 1.68 billion through growth credit across 32 deals in 2025, with Mumbai leading in both deal count and capital deployed. Fintech also dominated growth credit, accounting for 59 per cent of total capital deployed, followed by consumer at 13 per cent, and B2B at 11 per cent. The report highlighted that venture debt

has expanded significantly over the past decade, with annual deployments rising from USD 80 million in 2018 to USD 1.3 billion in 2025, marking a more than 16-fold increase and a compound annual growth rate of about 37 per cent.

Venture debt now accounts for around 9 per cent of total venture capital deployment annually, compared to about 2-3 per cent historically, suggesting rising founder acceptance of non-dilutive capital.

Stage-wise, venture debt remains concentrated in Series A and B funding rounds, accounting for about 60 per

CLOSER LOOK

» 'Venture debt deployments reached about \$1.3 bn across nearly 187 startups in 2025'

» Activity remained concentrated in major startup hubs, with Delhi-NCR leading at \$617 mn across 64 deals, followed by Bengaluru at \$333 mn across 58 deals and Mumbai at \$115 mn across 30 deals

» Consumer-focused startups led in deal volume (60)

MPOST BUREAU

SIRSA (HARYANA): Union Fisheries secretary Abhilash Likhi visited Sirsa district on Wednesday to review the progress of saline water aquaculture clusters developed under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana and interact with shrimp farmers.

During the visit, Likhi engaged with shrimp and fish farmers to understand on-ground challenges and gaps in implementation. Addressing the farmers, he emphasised the adoption of technology-driven shrimp farming practices, scientific pond management and robust biosecurity measures, along with sustained capacity building to improve productivity, product quality and profitability.

He highlighted that saline-affected regions like Sirsa hold significant potential for optimal land use through shrimp aquaculture, which can aid income diversification, generate employment and strengthen the rural economy. He also directed the Marine Products



Export Development Authority to extend technical guidance, support capacity building and help farmers establish export linkages. Stressing infrastructure needs, he underscored the importance of ensuring easy local availability of testing kits.

A review meeting was held in hybrid mode at Chaudhary Devi Lal University to assess cluster-based fisheries initiatives under PMMSY. Over 500 participants, including officials, scientists and stakeholders from across states, attended the meeting.

Farmers raised concerns over high and erratic electricity supply, dependence on other states for quality seed and inadequate water availability, and sought leasing of panchayat land to Self Help Groups to expand shrimp farming.

'Illicit trade threatens consumers, economy'

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Union Consumer Affairs minister Pralhad Joshi on Tuesday termed illicit trade a "shadow economy", warning that smuggling and counterfeiting pose serious risks to consumers and the broader economy.

Addressing a seminar on "Protecting Consumers: Addressing the Threat of Smuggling and Counterfeiting" organised by FICCI CASCADE, Joshi said such activities expose consumers to un-safe and substandard products, undermine honest businesses and erode government revenues meant for public welfare. He stressed that consumer protection must go beyond safety to ensuring "consumer prosperity".

Highlighting government efforts, he cited initiatives like the Central Consumer Protection Authority, National Consumer Helpline and the Jago Grahak campaign as key tools for em-powering citizens. He called for collective action by government, industry and society to tackle the menace.

Union Consumer Affairs secretary Nidhi Khare said India's consumer protection framework has evolved into a technology-driven system. She noted that grievance redressal timelines have reduced significantly, with some online complaints now resolved within 72 hours. Khare also pointed to the dual role of e-commerce platforms, stating that while they require regulatory oversight, they are increasingly taking steps such as delisting counterfeit products.

FICCI CASCADE chairman Anil Rajput called for a shift to preventive and technology-driven enforcement, while experts stressed stronger border controls and inter-agency coordination.



UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Mahanari Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 01352763008 Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SG0025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

RO No. 284
Corrigendum/Addendum - 02 Date: 08.04.2026
In the E- Tender No: CH(Main)-: 20/2025-26 in Section-3: Instructions To Tenderers And Eligibility Criteria at clause no: 7- Requirement of EPF Registration is hereby omitted.
All other terms & condition will be same as previously and dates are extended as per following
Last date of downloading tender: 15.04.2026, 16:00 Hrs
Last date of submission of tender: 15.04.2026, 16:00 Hrs
Date & Time of opening of tender: 16.04.2026, 11:00 Hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in".
(Executive Engineer, Maint., Chibro)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-AUCTION NOTICE
Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for the allotment of Deluxe Pay & Use Toilet Contracts on MOT Basis, at following Railway stations/locations:

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
PayNUse-3-2026	23.02.2026 at 12:00 hrs.	Hazrat Nizamuddin (NZM) 03 Sites, Delhi (DLI) 01 Site, Anand Vihar (ANVT) 01 Site & Panipat 01 Site (PNP) Total 6 Sites.

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen	https://ireps.gov.in/
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All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:
• Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module
• Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module
• Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details. • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism.
The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (If activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions. • Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055 E-Mail: sanitationcell@gmail.com Tel.:011-23743084
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No. 7PUB/TN/Pay&Use Toilets/Auction/2022 Dated: 07.04.2026 1158/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Notice For E-AUCTION
Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/FS, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, in terms of Railway Board letter no. 2022/TC(FM)/10 dated 13.06.2022, invites bids through e-Auction (www.ireps.gov.in) for the contract of Parking cum management of all types and class of vehicles and Stacking of Parcels at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station (NZM) towards Bhogal Side near Platform No.1, Okhla End with area measuring 938.14 sq. meters invited for a period of five years through E-Auction in IREPS module as per detail and schedule given below:-

S. No	Date & time of Auction	Assets to be auctioned
1	21.04.2026 at 11:00 hrs.	The contract of Parking cum management of all types and class of vehicles and Stacking of Parcels at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station (NZM) towards Bhogal Side near Platform No.1, Okhla End with area measuring 938.14 sq. meters (as per the site map uploaded) invited for a period of five years through E-Auction in IREPS module

Important notes: 4. For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding these e-Auctions, interested bidders are advised to visit https://www.ireps.gov.in/html/helpdesk/learning_centre.html. (E-Auction leasing section), 5. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD): 10% of the total contractual bid value to be deposited online during the auction, EMD of the successful bidder will be retained as Security Deposit. 6. Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute rights to short terminate these contracts at any point of time and/or for taking any decision regarding the discontinuation/continuation of these contracts with modified/additional terms and conditions depending upon the situations.
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1160/26



RAIL COACH FACTORY KAPURTHALA

On-line bids are invited by PCMM/RCF on behalf of President of India for the following item(s):-

Sr.No.	Tender No. & Due Date	Brief Description	Qty.(Nos/Sets)	EMD(₹)
1.	02261117/04.05.2026	Harness of LHB EOG Non-AC LSCN Coaches with FDB on Cabin Side Area Only	-	2000000/-
2.	17261018/27.04.2026	Design, Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Interior Furnishing Items of One Rake Set for HS-Spart Rake Configuration Consists of 04 Coaches	2 Sets	10,51,720/-
3.	02261116/04.05.2026	Harness of LHB EOG Non-AC LSCN Coaches with FDB on Cabin Side Area Only	-	2000000/-
4.	12261045/28.04.2026	Wider Window For LHB SCN Coaches (Size 1460 x 700, With Sliding Shutters), As Per Drawing : LS54124 Alt e To PL Number -33560390	1370 Nos.	4,30,020/-
5.	05261208/04.05.2026	INTEGRATED WTCC PL.No. 335656210	153 Nos.	216650/-
6.	05261209/04.05.2026	Set of END Construction for Memu/TC/3PH Coach PL.No. 30988810	40 Set	182660/-
7.	05261207/04.05.2026	Set of Integrated WTCC & Support Assly For LHB 455 Ltrs	208 Set	594750/-

1. For details and making On-line bids, visit Website <http://ireps.gov.in> Drawings/specifications, wherever required can be downloaded from RCF Website <http://www.rcf.indianrailways.gov.in>. Class IIIb digital signature certificate required for on-line bidding, can be obtained from licensed certifying agencies listed at website <http://www.cce.gov.in>. 2. All Limited tenders and Advertised tenders will normally close at 11:25 Hrs and 14:25 Hrs respectively on the stipulated date and will be opened at 11.30 Hrs and 14.30 Hrs. 3. Tenders at **Sr. No. 1** to 7 will be opened at RCF, Kapurthala 4. For queries contact IREPS Helpdesk at 011-24102855, 011-24105180 or RCF Helpdesk at 011-23378658. **NOTE:** "GST No. of RCF is 03AAAGM0289C1ZT. All the suppliers are advised to quote this in dispatch documents for the supplies made by them". **PCMM**
CORRIGENDUM- Tender No. (1) 17261125 Due on 29.04.2026 for Procurement of Set of Seat and Berth For L.H.B. SLR Amrit Bharat Coaches, regarding Special Conditions may be read as **attached as Annexure A. Tender No. (2) 05251643** for Procurement of Set of Under Frame Items for LHB SCN Coaches. **Due date may be read as 23.04.2026** Instead of 02.04.2026. **Tender No. (3) 17261004, Due date may be read as 17.04.2026** Instead of 07.04.2026. **Tender No. (4) 17261006 Due date may be read as 17.04.2026** Instead of 07.04.2026 and in Drawings instead of existing, to be read as Additional Drawings Added. **Tender No. (5) 17261135 Due on 20.04.2026**, Description may be read as Modified under P.L. No. 33693390. **PCMM**
R.O. No. 004-S/2026-27 Dated : 08.04.2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-II, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work:

1	Name of work	Repairs and Renovation of Offices and Shed at NDLS Sick Line, Almeri Gate, New Delhi including Flooring Work. Repair to Leaky Roof, Replacement of Broken Doors and Windows. Provision of Toilet, Renovation of Toilet Blocks by Replacing Sanitary Fittings, white washing and other Misc. work in the section of SSE/II/NDLS under ADEN/NDLS.
2	Approx cost of work	Rs.1,99,17,362.47/- (Rupees One Crore Ninety Nine Lakh Seventeen Thousand Three Hundred Sixty Two and Forty Seven Paise Only)
3	Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 3,98,40,000/- (Rupees Three Lakh Ninety Eight Thousand Four Hundred Only)
4	Cost of tender document	Rs.0.00/-
5	Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	30.04.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
6	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
7	Allocation	04-410-32

• The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. • For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. • Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. **No. 128-W/200/e Tender Notice/NIT/02/2026-27/W-3 Dated :- 07.04.2026 1164/2026**
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sagar Kohali S/o** Nand Kishore **R/o:** H.No. 2155, Ghat No.-29, Jamna Bazar, Kashmir Gate, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 47/2022, U/S 323/341/34 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sagar Kohali** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sagar Kohali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Sagar Kohali** the said accused of **FIR No. 47/2022, U/S 323/341/34 IPC, PS Kashmir Gate, North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.06.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11, Central Distt., Court No.-138, 1st Floor, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/4422/N/2026
(Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.
E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG - C- 2026-68
Description of work : Replacement of 2 nos old steel over head tanks with 2 Nos RCC Over Head Tank with Capacity 110000 Liters under ADEN/Lalitpur jurisdiction.
Approx Cost : 10132257.96 Earnest Money : 202700.00
Date of completion /period from issue acceptance letter. 12 Months
Date of closing Tender : 30/04/2026 at 15:00 hrs., Tender on line can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 30.04.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in **754/26 (D)**
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Manish Tanwar S/o** Sh. Om Parkash **R/o** Flat No. A-12, 1st Floor, Vijay Vihar, Phase-II, Rohini, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 50/2020 u/s 420/467/468/471/406/120-B IPC** at P.S. EOW, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Manish Tanwar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manish Tanwar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Manish Tanwar** accused of **FIR No. 50/2020 u/s 420/467/468/471/406/120-B IPC** at P.S. EOW, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **15.05.2026**.
By Order: Ms. Upasana Satija,
Chief Judicial Magistrate (North-West)
Room No. 108, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4571/EOW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pawan @ Monu, S/o** Sh. Ashok Kumar **R/o** H. No. 7442, Tel Mill Gali, Nabi Karim, Delhi, **also at:** H.No. 7400, Katra Tel Mill Gali, Ram Nagar, Nabi Karim, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 222/2023 u/s 380/457/411/34 IPC** at **P.S. Nabi Karim, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Pawan @ Monu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pawan @ Monu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pawan @ Monu** accused of **FIR No. 222/2023 u/s 380/457/411/34 IPC** at **P.S. Nabi Karim, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **20.05.2026**.
By Order: Dr. Raj Kumar Singh,
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-05, (Central), Central District, Room No.-241, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/4523/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Geeta D/o** Suresh Kumar **R/o** A-12, C-Block, Aman Vihar, Kirari Suleman Nagar, Sultanpuri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case **FIR No. 870/19 u/s 498A/406/34 IPC** at **P.S. Raj Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Geeta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Geeta** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Geeta** accused of **FIR No. 870/19 u/s 498A/406/34 IPC** at **P.S. Raj Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **12.05.2026**.
By Order: Ms. Aishwarya Sharma,
Judicial Magistrate First Class, (Mahila Court-01, North West) Court No. 106, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4539/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Govinda, S/o. Sita Ram, R/o:** Vegabond Near Fateh Nagar, Gurudwara Jail Road, Hari Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.691/2021 U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act** registered at **P.S Hari Nagar, West District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Govinda** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Govinda** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Govinda**, accused of **FIR No.691/2021 U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S Hari Nagar, West District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.05.2026**.
By Order, Moksha Bains,
DP/4546/WD/2026 Judicial Magistrate First Class-II (West),
(Court Matter) Room No. 31, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.



New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tenders are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.com & <http://etender.up.nic.in> Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments/corrigendum etc.
1. 23/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2025-26, Strengthening of Sewerage (S/F of 600 mm dia Reflex Valve on Raising the Manhole of SPS and Allied Civil Work SPS-66), Noida. Cost ₹ 15.38 Lacs
2. 24/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2025-26, M/o Sewerage (Repairing of Damaged Sewer and Water Line Different Places Community Health Center in Bhangel Sector-110), Noida. Cost ₹ 26.75 Lacs
Which can be uploaded by date:-15.04.2026 upto 5.00 PM.
Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: 16.04.2026 at 11.00 AM. **General Manager (Jal)**
Office: Sector-5 NOIDA
CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 26/12 Date: 07.04.2026
E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit) invites the following E-Procurement Tenders.

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	60255017	Electric Overhead Traveling crane	1 Set.	30.04.2026
2	30262736	BALL JOINT ROLL LINK FOR FIAT BOGIE OF LHB COACHES	8084 Nos.	28.04.2026
3	38251900	POH KIT FOR C3W2 TYPE DISTRIBUTOR VALVE	697 Nos.	16.04.2026
4	38263277	TOP SIDE BEARER LINER	7830 Nos.	20.04.2026
5	90261091	MS FLAT 40 X 6 MM	118251 Kgs	23.04.2026
6	70253058B	Brazing Rod	177 Kgs.	29.04.2026
7	20255023	Set of dampers (Shock Absorbers) for WAP-7 loco	30 set	29.04.2026

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper. **760/26 (MG)**
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. 0220262027 Date: 06.04.2026
E-Tendering Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-TENDERS on prescribed form for the following work up to **13.30 hrs. on 29.04.2026**. The details of the Tender are as under:-

S. N. : 1	Tender No.:	05	Approx. Cost of work (₹) :	₹ 7948384.39
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Name of work: Combined tender for (A) Interlocking of Non- Interlocked LC Gate No. 8HK in HRS-HRF Section. (B) Provision of New Sub-station Buildings at CRS Tundla and Hathras in place of old and dilapidated buildings under Sr. DENI/PRYJ.
Bid Security (₹) : ₹ 159000.00

S. N. : 2	Tender No.:	06	Approx. Cost of work (₹) :	₹ 6825398.33
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Name of work: Extension of BLC Monitoring Centre at 1st floor of existing monitoring building at Tundla under ADEN/TL.
Bid Security (₹) : ₹ 136500.00
Completion Period : 8 months **Date of Opening of tender :** 29.04.2026
Eligibility Criteria for Similar work : Construction of Building.
(1) E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. (2) The complete information along with tender document of above E-TENDER is available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e., 29.04.2026. (3) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (4) The tenderers shall submit a copy of certificate as given in tender document in standard format, without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. (5) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. (6) The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC April '2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete offer and accordingly shall not be considered. **758/26(DG)**
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-April-02 **Dated:** 06.04.2026
E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line Only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:-

S.No.:	1	Tender No.:	2026-April-02-01	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 8863224.77
Description of work:	Misc. P.way works in the jurisdiction of SSE/Pway/BNR under ADEN-II/MTJ.				
S.No.:	2	Tender No.:	2026-April-02-02	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 13595156.17
Description of work:	(A) TRR(P) of 18.015 Km in MTJ-PWL section & Misc. P.way works under Sr. DENI-Agra (B) RDE- Provision of a crossover at MTJ end between 3rd & 4th line. (C) Provision for extension of UP loop line at RNKA Yard.				
S.No.:	3	Tender No.:	2026-April-02-03	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 461250539.10
Description of work:	Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/P. Way under Sr. DENI/Agra.				
S.No.:	4	Tender No.:	2026-April-02-04	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 7624445.72
Description of work:	Construction of 12 beds RPF barrack at Brjnagar railway station and construction of female Changing Room along with Rest Room, Female and Male Lockups and Record room at RPF out post Brjnagar.				
S.No.:	5	Tender No.:	2026-April-02-05	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 3073253.74
Description of work:	Replacement of Roof & Repair of Type-I Quarters at BDM & GDO stations in MTJ-AWR section.				

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" upto 15.00 hrs on 28.04.2026. **759/26(A)**
North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-April-01 **Dated:** 06.04.2026
E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:-

S.No.:	1	Tender No.:	2026-April-01-01	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 23455930.59
Description of work:	BFP- Development of store facilities at SSE/PW/INAGC office.				
S.No.: <td>2</td> <td>Tender No.:<th>2026-April-01-02</th><th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th><th>₹ 12828574.45</th></td>	2	Tender No.: <th>2026-April-01-02</th> <th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th> <th>₹ 12828574.45</th>	2026-April-01-02	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 12828574.45
Description of work:	Improvement to colony road, approach road to RCC OHT & RPF barrack & mehtab bagh to qtr no. 14/T at JAB under jurisdiction of SSE/VIIDH under ADEN/HQ/AGC.				
S.No.: <td>3</td> <td>Tender No.:<th>2026-April-01-03</th><th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th><th>₹ 12864717.32</th></td>	3	Tender No.: <th>2026-April-01-03</th> <th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th> <th>₹ 12864717.32</th>	2026-April-01-03	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 12864717.32
Description of work:	Misc. P.way work for SSE(P.Way)AA under ADEN-HQ, Agra				
S.No.: <td>4</td> <td>Tender No.:<th>2026-April-01-04</th><th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th><th>₹ 867184.71</th></td>	4	Tender No.: <th>2026-April-01-04</th> <th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th> <th>₹ 867184.71</th>	2026-April-01-04	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 867184.71
Description of work:	Sale of abandoned quarters and service buildings on as is where is basis including wood, iron & ferrous material and other serviceable materials including disposal of unserviceable materials as directed by Engineer in-charge in IDH.				
S.No.: <td>5</td> <td>Tender No.:<th>2026-April-01-05</th><th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th><th>₹ 58168015.67</th></td>	5	Tender No.: <th>2026-April-01-05</th> <th>Approx. Cost (Rs.):</th> <th>₹ 58168015.67</th>	2026-April-01-05	Approx. Cost (Rs.):	₹ 58168015.67
Description of work:	Creation of Divisional Stores Depot at Agra Division.				

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" upto 15.00 hrs on 27.04.2026. **751/26(A)**
North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

DC FINISHED ON 209 FOR 8 IN PURSUIT OF 211

GT win last ball thriller after Miller’s brain fade moment

NEW DELHI: Gujarat Titans secured their first win of the season following a roller coaster last over as a rampaging David Miller’s momentary indiscretion cost Delhi Capitals dearly in an IPL match here on Wednesday. Miller refused the single off the penultimate delivery of the final bowled by Prasidh Krishna underlining his lack of trust in partner Kuldeep Yadav. Prasidh bowled a pace-off slower which Miller missed and Jos Buttler having taken one glove off broke down the stumps before Kuldeep could make it.

Delhi Capitals finished agonisingly short on 209 for 8 in pursuit of 211. Jos Buttler (52 off 27) returned to his ballistic ways with a six laden half century before captain Shubman Gill (70 off) and Washington Sundar (55 off 32) powered Gujarat Titans to 210 for four.

Rahul (92 off 52) and Pathum Nissanka (41 off 24) provided an ideal platform for Delhi Capitals with a 76-run stand off 49 balls. However, Rashid Khan struck thrice in the middle overs to wrest the momentum from Delhi Capitals.

Titans had all under control until the 19th over with the home needing 36 off the last two overs.

It was a tough ask but with Miller (41 not out off 20) returning to the centre after treating his finger in the dressing room, there was hope.

Miller singlehandedly brought back Delhi Capitals in the game with a couple of cracking sixes and a four in a 23-run penultimate over from Mohammed Siraj.

With majority of Titans pacers’ proving expensive on the night, the experienced Prasidh Krishna was left to defend 13 off the last six balls.

Vipraj Nigam departed after a four off the first ball, leaving Miller with 8 to get off the last three balls.



Delhi Capitals’ David Miller (right), interacts with Gujarat Titans’ Kagiso Rabada after losing the match during an Indian Premier League (IPL) match between Delhi Capitals and Gujarat Titans, at Arun Jaitley Stadium, in New Delhi on Wednesday

What followed was mammoth hit over long-off that almost sealed the deal for Delhi Capitals. Such was Miller’s state of mind that he refused a single on the penultimate ball and that proved to be decisive in the end.

With 2 needed off the final ball, Prasidh went for a slow bouncer that was not connected by Miller, who went for the run leaving Kuldeep Yadav short of his crease.

The review was called for a wide but it was deemed a fair delivery, leaving Miller disappointed. It was the first loss of the season for Delhi Capitals in as many games while Titans finally logged home full points in third attempt.

Earlier, Buttler smashed five sixes at the Kotla.

Four of those maximums came off medium pacer Mukesh Kumar (2/55 in 4 overs), who had an off day after starring in the previous game against Mumbai Indians..

19

Titans had all under control until the 19th over with the home needing 36 off the last two overs

Buttler went hard at Mukesh in the fifth over of the innings, collecting 23 runs via three hits that went all the way.

One was over fine leg after he shuffled across the stumps, the second was a massive strike that reached the top tier of the “Gautam Gambhir Stand” and three balls later, he targetted the extra cover region.

Buttler’s onslaught helped Delhi Capitals reached 68 for one in the powerplay. He was

dismissed against the run of play, off a long hop from Kuldeep Yadav.

Gill, a mere spectator when Buttler was batting, took the onus on himself to clear the ropes after Buttler’s departure.

Four of his five sixes came off India teammate Kuldeep with the Titans captain using the slog sweep effectively against the wrist spinner.

Titans have been labelled as a top heavy team with middle order not being tested enough. Washington Sundar on Wednesday played his part well at number four.

The southpaw picked the mid-wicket boundary against the spinners especially Vipraj Nigam who leaked 23 runs in the 12th over.

Washington reached his half century with a six over deep square leg off T Natarajan.

At 161 for two in 15 overs, Titans were on course for 220 but fell short.

KKR may finally get Green bowling boost against LSG

KOLKATA: Star Australian all-rounder Cameron Green may finally be seen bowling for Kolkata Knight Riders in IPL 2026 when three-time champions face Lucknow Super Giants here on Thursday, offering a lift to their depleted bowling stock.

Green has not bowled so far this season following a back surgery, and he has been gradually building up his workload in the nets.

The Australian bowled at full throttle on the eve of KKR’s match against Punjab Kings on Monday and again sent down a few overs during Tuesday’s training session before it was cut short by a thunderstorm.

On the eve of their match against LSG, Green spent over 30 minutes at nets with full intent before another heavy thunderstorm, accompanied by strong winds and down-pour, forced an early end to practice.

Badminton Asia C’ships: Ayush stuns world No. 7 Feng; Sindhu, Prannoy win

NINGBO: India’s Ayush Shetty stunned world No. 7 Lin Shi Feng of China in straight games to enter the second round of the men’s singles competition at the Badminton Asia Championships here on Wednesday.

World No. 25 Ayush, who had won the US Open Super 300 title last year, registered a 21-13 21-16 victory in 51 minutes.

Lin raced to a 4-1 lead early on, but Ayush clawed back to level at 7-7 before gradually taking control to pocket the opening game.

After the change of sides, the Chinese again moved ahead 4-1 and extended it to 12-9, but Ayush turned the tide with a six-point burst to surge to 18-13.

Lin closed the gap to 16-18, but the Indian held his nerve to shut the door on his fancied opponent.

PV Sindhu defeated Malaysia’s Wong Ling Ching in women’s singles 15-21, 21-11, 21-19 in 1 hour and 7 minutes. She will next face World No. 2 Wang Zhi Yi of China in the



PV Sindhu



HS Prannoy

Takeaways

- » World No. 25 Ayush registered a 21-13 21-16 victory in 51 minutes
- » V Sindhu defeated Malaysia’s Wong Ling Ching in women’s singles 15-21, 21-11, 21-19 in 1 hour and 7 minutes
- » Lakshya Sen, Kidambi Srikanth, Malvika Bansod and Tanvi Sharma exited in the opening round
- » In men’s singles, HS Prannoy beat Nguyen Hai Dang of Vietnam 24-22, 21-12 in 47 minutes

pre-quarterfinals both having 3-3 win-loss in past meetups.

In men’s singles, HS Prannoy beat Nguyen Hai Dang of Vietnam 24-22, 21-12 in 47 minutes. He will meet Hong Yang of China in the pre-quar-

terfinals after the latter received a walkover in the opening round.

Lakshya Sen, Kidambi Srikanth, Malvika Bansod and Tanvi Sharma exited in the opening round.

Vaishnavi, Sahaja power India to 3-0 sweep over New Zealand in BJK Cup

Vaishnavi struck again in 5th game, converting her 2ND break point to extend lead

Sahaja vs Valentina

In yet another heavy baseline slugfest, Sahaja played some superb forehand drives and looked in good touch as she took the court again for the second time on Wednesday.

She broke her opponent in the first game itself after converting two break points. The Indian was then broken by Valentina but she broke back again in the third game to go 2-1 up.

Sahaja controlled the rally and with great anticipation eventually took the opening set 6-1. Sahaja took the momentum to the next set. She stayed in the rally and waited for her opponent to make mistakes. The Indian broke Valentina in the second game and then held her own to go 3-1. If the fifth game, a cross court winner helped Sahaja move to 4-1, Valentina too held her serve as it was 4-2.

marked improvement, executing her shots with far greater control to outplay Aishi Das 6-2 6-4 in one hour and 30 minutes.

Sahaja then outclassed Val-

entina Ivanov 6-1 6-3 in the second singles to keep their campaign alive. In the doubles, Rutuja Bhosale and Ankita Raina recorded a 6-4 6-2 win over the combination of world

No. 11 Erin Routliffe and world no. 338 Monique Barry to complete the drubbing.

Vaishnavi capitalised on Das’ inconsistency to take control of the opening set.

Despite trailing 15-40 early on serve, the Indian earned the first break as Das squandered a 40-15 lead with a string of errors. She then held through a tight deuce battle to move 2-0 ahead.

Vaishnavi showed resilience under pressure in the third game, saving two break points, and maintained her advantage as both players held their serve to 3-1.

The Indian struck again in the fifth game, converting her second break point to extend the lead.

Leisure

HALLE SHARES FACING RACIST REACTIONS FOR ‘THE LITTLE MERMAID’

The 2023 film received criticism from racist fans who were furious over a Black actor portraying Ariel

Halle Bailey finally opened up about working on ‘The Little Mermaid’ remake and how she insulated herself from racist reactions.

While on the press tour for her latest film, ‘You, Me & Tuscany’, the American singer-actress told ‘The Independent’ that ‘The Little Mermaid’ was ‘a beautiful experience’ for her despite facing online harassment by racist trolls.

“It was actually freeing to be in the middle of this conversation where so many different opinions were coming in and they were so opposite from one another... I felt like I was watching myself inside a cup, seeing how people react to it. Growing up in the industry can really develop your sense of self and for me, it keeps me grounded in a way. I know for some people it’s the opposite, but I just always think to myself, ‘None of this is real,’ she said.

The 2023 live-action of Disney’s popular animated film had received much criticism from racist fans who were furious over a Black actor portraying Ariel. However, just before the film’s theatre release, Bailey told ‘The Face’ that ‘as a Black person you just expect’ the racist antagonism and ‘it’s not really a shock anymore’.

Bailey’s upcoming romantic comedy film ‘You, Me & Tuscany’, co-starring ‘Bridgerton’ actor Rege-Jean Page and directed by Kat Coira, is set for release on April 10.



Bailey said ‘as a Black person, you just expect’ the racist antagonism and ‘it’s not really a shock anymore’



Oscars set dates for 99th and 100th broadcast

The 99th Oscars will be held on March 14, 2027

The organisation that puts on the Oscars has set dates for its final two shows on ‘ABC’, including the 100th Academy Awards.

The Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences and ABC said on Tuesday that the 99th Oscars will be held on March 14, 2027 and the 100th on March 5, 2028. They will be the last ceremonies broadcast on its longtime network home before the show moves to ‘YouTube’ in 2029 and the last two held at the Dolby Theatre in Hollywood.

The film academy just recently announced that the show would also have a new physical location at the Peacock Theatre in downtown Los Angeles as part of a 10-year agreement with AEG.

‘ABC’ and the film academy will continue to air the show at its earlier time of 7 pm Eastern/4 pm Pacific.



The film academy announced that the show would also have a new physical location at the Peacock Theatre in downtown Los Angeles

The 98th Oscars last month saw a nine per cent dip in ratings after several years of gains.

Conan O’Brien returned to host the show, which saw ‘One

Battle After Another’ take best picture and director, Michael B Jordan win ‘Best Actor’, for ‘Sinners’ and Jessie Buckley pick up best actress, for ‘Hamnet’.

SAQIB GETS CANDID ABOUT STEPPING INTO SSP SAMARDEEP

Saleem currently stars in Amazon MX Player’s ‘Kaptaan’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Amazon MX Player recently launched its gritty cop drama, ‘Kaptaan’, set against the charged backdrop of Jwalabad. The series pulls viewers into a volatile world driven by power, ambition and constantly shifting loyalties. Headlined by Saqib Saleem and Siddharth Nigam, ‘Kaptaan’ also boasts a stellar ensemble cast featuring Anjum Shharma,



Kavita Kaushik, Pooja Gor, Anushka Kaushik and others.

Opening up about what drew him to the role, Saqib Saleem shared, “Honestly, the first thing that stood out

to me was that Samardeep doesn’t try to be a hero. He isn’t chasing validation. He walks into a room and the energy shifts. That kind of presence is rare to find on paper. Also, he speaks very little, which works great for me. In real life, too, I’d pick fewer lines and more attitude any day.”

“But on a serious note, what really stayed with me is that everything he does comes from a deeply personal place,” he added.



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Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

(1) Name of the Constituency - **121- Haroa Assembly Constituency**

(2) Name of the candidate – **Muhammad Abdul Matin**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 341/326/307/427/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1.C.R.M. Case No. 8237/2010 (arising out of P.S. CaseNo. 157/2010, dated 17.05.2010, Deganga Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Barasat Court
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. Yes, on 25.07.2010
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere "winnability" at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **121- Haroa Assembly Constituency**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Muhammad Abdul Matin**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



 Derek O'Brien
 Member, National Working Committee,
 All India Trinamool Congress

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Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

(1) Name of the Constituency - **77-Karimpur Assembly Constituency**

(2) Name of the candidate – **Soham Chakraborty**

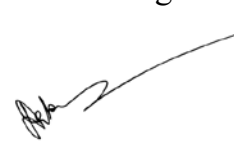
Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Sections 341/323/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	G.R. Case No. 666/24 (arising out of P.S. Case No. 85/24, dated 08.06.2024, Technocity Police Station, Bidhannagar Police Commissionerate, Akandakesari, Kolkata-135)
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned A.C.J.M at Barasat, North 24 Parganas.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere "winnability" at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **77-Karimpur Assembly Constituency**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Soham Chakraborty**

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(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

(1) Name of the Constituency - **155- Maheshtala Assembly Constituency**

(2) Name of the candidate – **Subhasis Das**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Sections 66 (c) of Information Technology Act, 2000 and Sections 465/468/469/471 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	GR Case No. 509/2018 (arising in connection with P.S.Case No. 26/2018, Lal Bazar Police Station, Dist.-Kolkata)
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned C.M.M at Calcutta
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable

	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **155- Maheshtala Assembly Constituency**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Subhasis Das**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

- (1) Name of the Constituency - 198-Tarakeswar Assembly Constituency
- (2) Name of the candidate – Ramendu Sinharay

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 147/148/149/325/427/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2.Sections 147/148/149/323/324/333/186 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 3.Sections 147/148/149/427/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 4.Sections 341/325/323/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1.FIR No.80/2010, dated 13.05.10, Tarakeswar Police Station) 2.FIR No.15/2010, dated 16.01.10, Tarakeswar Police Station) 3.FIR No.94/2010, dated 27.05.10, Tarakeswar Police Station) 4.FIR No.90/16, dated 20.05.16, Dhaniakhali Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Chandannagar Court. 2. Chandannagar Court. 3. Chandannagar Court. 4. Chinsurah Court.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	N. A
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	N. A
	g.	Any other information required to be given	N. A
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 198-Tarakeswar Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Ramendu Sinharay

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

- (1) Name of the Constituency - 157-Metiaburuz Assembly Constituency
- (2) Name of the candidate – Adbul Khaleque Molla

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 147/148/149/323/427/337/307 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 148/149/435/506/380 of Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1.Session Case No. 72(11)/2009(arising out of P.S. Case No. 34(4)/2005, MetiabruzPolice Station) 2.P.S. Case No. 32(4) of 2005, MetiabruzPolice Station).
	c.	Name of the Court	1.Learned District& Sessions Judge, Alipore, South 24 Parganas. 2.Learned 7th Judicial Magistrate Alipore, South 24 Parganas.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	N. A
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	N. A
	g.	Any other information required to be given	N. A
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 157-Metiaburuz Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Adbul Khaleque Molla

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 1- Mekliganj(SC)Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Paresh Chandra Adhikary

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences Alleged Under: Sections 420/467/468/471/477A, Sect read with Sections 120B/201/109 of IPC, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	Special Case No. 04/2025 (Arising out of RC010 2022 A0004, dated 18-05-2022, CBI A.C.B. Kolkata).
	c.	Name of the Court	1 st Special Judge (CBI) at Alipore.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	Yes, on 11-09-2025
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		
	The candidate on the basis of his demonstrated public engagement, transparency, and commitment towards society. He has duly disclosed all assets, liabilities, and pending cases in accordance with law, reflecting accountability and adherence to statutory requirements. The candidate is actively involved in social work and has consistently contributed towards the welfare and development of the community. His background indicates sustained public interaction and service-oriented activities. The selection has been made on the basis of merit, integrity, and public service orientation, and not merely on electoral winnability.		
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 1- Mekliganj(SC)Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Paresh Chandra Adhikary

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien

Member, National Working Committee,

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Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 124 – Basirhat Dakshin Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Surajit Mitra

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Sections 147/149/325/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	G.R. Case No. 115/2017, (Arising out of Basirhat P.S Case No. 36/2017, dated – 09/01/2017, Basirhat Police Station, North 24 Parganas).
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Basirhat
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is selected based on merit, demonstrated through extensive grassroots experience, consistent public engagement, and a strong record of advocating for marginalized communities. His approachability, deep understanding of local issues, and sustained commitment to public service highlight his capability to effectively represent constituents. These qualifications, along with proven achievements and integrity in community leadership, establish his readiness for legislative responsibilities, independent of electoral winnability considerations.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 124 – Basirhat Dakshin Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Surajit Mitra

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party

Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien

Member, National Working Committee,

All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates
(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 190-Chunchura Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Debangshu Bhattacharya

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Section 188 of Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 3 of Epidemic Diseases Act 1897.
	b.	Case no.	PRC(SP) Case No. 05/2022, Arising Out of FIR No. 2021, TLM99, dated 07.08.21, Telliamura Police Station, West Tripura).
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned J.M 1 st Class Khowai Court.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable

	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 190-Chunchura Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Debangshu Bhattacharya

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party

Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien

Member, National Working Committee,

All India Trinamool Congress



AROUND THE WORLD

- » CBSE opens marks upload link for Class 12 West Asia schools
- » IIT Delhi has opened professional courses in AI leadership and quantum
- » IITM Pravartak partners with Maven Silicon to launch training program for working professionals in semiconductor tech
- » IMS Noida hosts 'Management Nexus,' bringing together 150 teams across Delhi-NCR



BUZZER ROUND

QJ WHICH INDIAN CITY IS KNOWN AS THE 'CITY OF PEARLS'?
Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our April 2 edition question:
Pune

Correct answers were sent by: **Nirmalya Mukherjee, Debdeep Rakshit, Rukmini Tibrewal**



NEWS & VIEWS

Nagaland University Researchers have developed a sustainable and robust hydrogel membrane electrolyte using the natural biopolymer chitosan that offers a safer and environmentally friendly alternative to conventional liquid electrolytes used in supercapacitors.

Masai has signed a Memorandum of Understanding with SP Jain Institute of Management & Research (SPJIMR) to launch pathway certification programmes for working professionals. The partnership brings together institutional legacy and grassroots accessibility to reimagine executive education.

NTA expands digital reach on social media



Students to receive instant exam updates on Instagram and Facebook

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The National Testing Agency (NTA) has strengthened its digital presence by officially launching its accounts on Instagram and Facebook, aiming to make exam-related updates more accessible and timely for students across the country. This move is expected to streamline communication and ensure that important information reaches aspirants without delay.

In a recent announcement shared on its official X (formerly Twitter) handle, the agency stated that it is now "closer than ever" to aspirants. Through these newly launched platforms, students will be able to receive instant notifications, exam alerts, and key updates in a more user-friendly format. The initiative is part of NTA's broader effort to enhance engagement with

candidates preparing for various national-level entrance examinations.

The agency highlighted that its social media presence will simplify access to crucial information such as admit cards, exam schedules, results, and other important announcements. With platforms like Instagram and Facebook being widely used among students, this step is likely to improve both the speed and convenience of communication.

To make it easier for candidates to find and follow its official pages, the NTA has also shared QR codes that directly link to its verified accounts. The official Instagram handle is @nta_india, while the Facebook page is available at @nta.exams. Students are encouraged to follow these accounts to stay informed and avoid missing any important updates.

In a recent announcement shared on its official X (formerly Twitter) handle, the agency stated that it is now "closer than ever" to aspirants

HARVARD ROLLS OUT FREE COURSES IN AI, DATA SCIENCE

Self-paced programmes designed for both students and working professionals

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Those looking to upskill in today's fast-evolving tech landscape can take advantage of a range of free online courses offered by Harvard University. Covering areas like artificial intelligence (AI), data science, and programming, these courses cater to both beginners and professionals seeking to enhance their knowledge. With flexible schedules and self-paced formats, learners can easily fit them into their routines.

DATA SCIENCE: BUILDING MACHINE LEARNING MODELS

This course introduces the core principles of machine learning, including widely used algorithms and techniques. Participants will learn how to apply cross-validation to prevent overfitting and explore key concepts such as regularization. It also includes building recommendation systems. The programme is self-paced and can be completed over eight weeks.

MACHINE LEARNING AND AI WITH PYTHON

In this six-week course, learners are



introduced to decision trees, a foundational algorithm in machine learning and artificial intelligence, helping build a strong base in the field.

CS50'S COMPUTER SCIENCE FOR BUSINESS

Focused on real-world applications of technology in business, this course covers computational thinking, programming languages, internet technologies, web

development, and cloud computing. Running till December 30, 2026, it offers flexibility for learners to progress at their own pace.

CS50'S UNDERSTANDING TECHNOLOGY

Ideal for beginners, this course introduces fundamental technology concepts, including the internet, multimedia, security, web development, and programming. Designed for non-

tech-savvy individuals, it is a six-week self-paced programme.

INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE WITH PYTHON

This hands-on course teaches how to use Python to solve real-world data science problems. Learners will work with libraries such as Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, and SKLearn, while also learning to build and evaluate basic machine learning models. It is an eight-week course available anytime.

CS50'S WEB PROGRAMMING WITH PYTHON AND JAVASCRIPT

This 12-week programme focuses on web development using tools like HTML, CSS, Git, Python, Django, SQL, and JavaScript. It typically requires a weekly commitment of 6-9 hours.

CS50'S INTRODUCTION TO PROGRAMMING WITH SCRATCH

A beginner-friendly offering, this course introduces core programming concepts such as functions, events, loops, conditions, and variables using Scratch. It is a three-week self-paced programme.

NMC CRACKS DOWN ON MEDICAL COLLEGES OVER EXCESS FEE



OUR CORRESPONDENT

The National Medical Commission (NMC) has issued a firm directive to medical colleges, institutions, and universities across India, mandating that MBBS fees be charged strictly for the stipulated academic duration of four and a half years. The commission has warned that any deviation from this rule will lead to stringent regulatory action.

This decision follows multiple complaints received by the NMC, indicating that several institutions were collecting fees for extended periods of five to five and a half years. In certain instances, colleges were also found to be charging students for the compulsory rotating medical internship, even though it does not fall under formal academic instruction.

Clarifying the official structure of the MBBS programme, the commission referred to provisions under

IN CERTAIN INSTANCES, COLLEGES WERE ALSO FOUND TO BE CHARGING STUDENTS FOR THE COMPULSORY ROTATING MEDICAL INTERNSHIP, EVEN THOUGH IT DOES NOT FALL UNDER FORMAL ACADEMIC INSTRUCTION

the National Medical Commission Act, 2019, along with the Competency-Based Medical Education (CBME) Guidelines, 2024, framed under the Graduate Medical Education Regulations (GMER). As per these guidelines, the MBBS course consists of 4.5 years (54 months) of academic study, followed by a one-year compulsory rotating medical internship (CRMI).

The NMC reiterated that the internship phase should not be considered part of the academic course for fee-related purposes, and therefore, institutions must not impose any additional charges for this period. The directive aims to prevent students from facing undue financial burden.

Citing interim

observations by the Supreme Court of India, the commission noted that issues such as non-payment of stipends during internships and the imposition of extra charges have been highlighted in related cases. The apex court has stressed that fee structures must remain fair, transparent, and non-exploitative, and should correspond only to the academic services provided.

Reaffirming its position, the NMC has directed all institutions to strictly adhere to the revised fee guidelines and limit charges exclusively to the 4.5-year academic period. The move is intended to enhance transparency and accountability in medical education while protecting students' interests.

IIM Calcutta awards degrees to 561 students at 61st convocation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The 61st Annual Convocation of IIM Calcutta conferred degrees to 561 graduating students including 459 students from the two-year MBA programmes and 90 students from the one-year MBAEx programme.

The ceremony was graced by Dr Praveer Sinha, Managing Director & CEO, The Tata Power Company Limited, as chief guest, along with Prof M Jagadesh Kumar, Chairperson, Board of Governors, and Prof Alok Kumar Rai, Director, IIM Calcutta.

In his address, Prof Rai reflected on a year of strong institutional progress driven by the collective efforts of the Institute's



community and the continued support of its stakeholders. Addressing the graduating class, he emphasised the importance of gratitude, purpose, and values, encouraging them to lead with integrity and make meaningful contributions as they step into the next phase of their journey.



IIT Madras TO TACKLE CHALLENGES IN CRYPTOGRAPHY AND AI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIT Madras researchers are set to address some of the most fundamental challenges in computing, spanning cryptography, Artificial Intelligence and quantum technologies through a major new research initiative focused on deep, theory-driven innovation with real-world impact.

The initiative will advance the mathematical foundations of computation while tackling critical open problems in areas such as data security, computational complexity, algorithms, and privacy in AI. By combining rigorous theoretical inquiry with practical applications, the effort aims to enable breakthroughs in secure digital infrastructure, resilient systems, and trustworthy AI.

This research will be taken up by Arvind Raghunathan Center for Theoretical Computer Science, which was recently launched with the support of a Rs 23 crore endowment from IIT Madras alumnus Arvind Raghunathan (1984/BT/EE).

By bridging theory and practice, this



A key outcome of this effort is the expansion of research beyond traditional cybersecurity into broader domains of theoretical computer science and applied mathematics

initiative is expected to play a pivotal role in strengthening India's capabilities in next-generation technologies, from secure digital systems to quantum computing, while establishing IIT Madras as a global centre of excellence in theoretical computer science.

A key outcome of this effort is the expansion of research beyond traditional cybersecurity into broader domains of theoretical computer science and applied mathematics. This includes foundational work in cryptographic systems, quantum computing, optimisation, and AI/ML theory. The research will directly inform emerging applications such as secure AI systems, blockchain technologies, quantum-safe cryptography, and distributed systems that enable digital trust at scale.



Trending COURSES

COURSES ON EMERGING TECHNOLOGIES & DESIGN FROM IIT GANDHINAGAR

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIT Gandhinagar has announced the launch of two new academic programmes, a Master of Design (MDes) programme and a Master of Technology (MTech) in Maritime Engineering programme from the upcoming academic year (2026-27).

Speaking about the initiative, Prof Bhaskar Datta, Dean, Academic Affairs, IIT Gandhinagar, said, "IIT Gandhinagar is focusing on areas expected to witness increased demand, with the objective of developing future-ready students." Building on the Institute's Design and Innovation Centre, the Master of Design programme will integrate design thinking

with engineering, technology, and social sciences. It is intended to strengthen systems thinking and collaborative problem-solving capabilities relevant to real-world challenges. Aligning with national initiatives such as the Sagarmala Programme, the MTech programme in Maritime Engineering will cover areas such as port and ocean infrastructure, logistics, and regulatory frameworks. Additionally, it will address gaps in maritime-focused education, particularly in Gujarat, a state known for its port activity and cargo traffic. Additionally, IITGN Research Park also provides various opportunities for students to explore entrepreneurial ideas, and work on applied projects.